Wireless 01 | Arista Wireless Setup

Overview

In this lab, we'll explore the Arista Launchpad in more depth and walk through how access points are onboarded, configured, and troubleshot in a live environment.

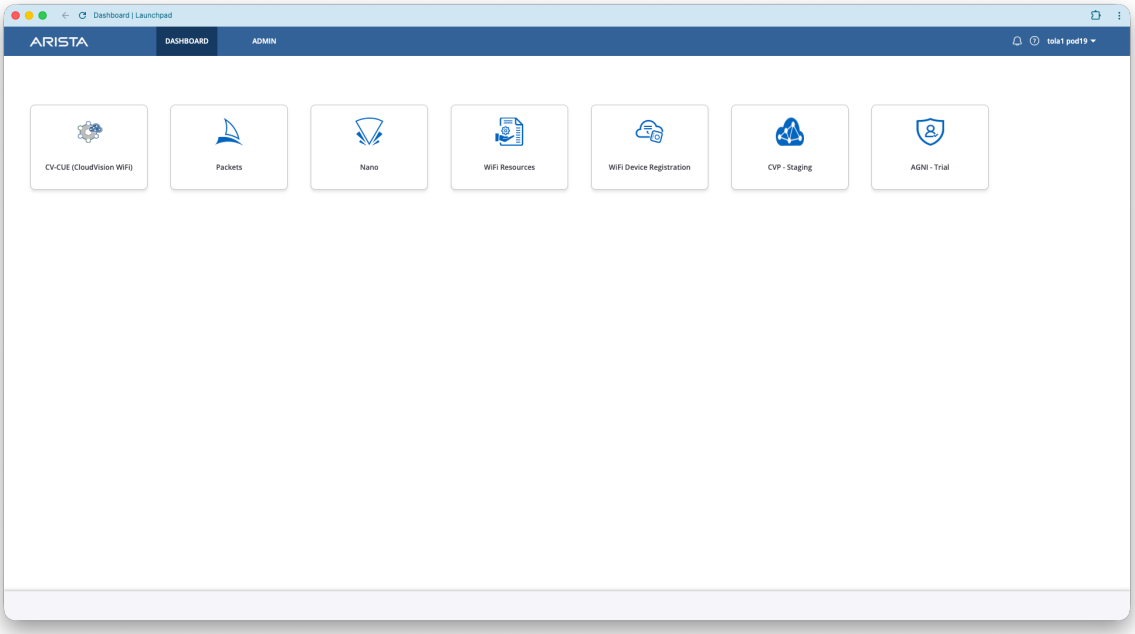
What you'll learn:

- Navigate Arista Launchpad and CV-CUE management interfaces
- Register and name access points in CV-CUE
- Build a location hierarchy with folders, floors, and groups
- Upload floor plans and place APs on the map
- Configure radio settings and create a PSK SSID

Open Launchpad | **Login Help** | **Lab Topology**

Arista Launchpad

Launchpad is the portal to access your Arista cloud services including **Wi-Fi Management (CV-CUE)** and **AGNI (Network Access Control)**. When you open the launcher, you are presented with management applications on the `Dashboard` menu and access controls with the `Admin` menu. Each is included with the subscription (as is support).



CV-CUE CloudVision-Wi-Fi: Wireless Manager.

Packets: an online .pcap debug allowing you to examine the packet information.

Nano: manage your environment from your smartphone

Wi-Fi Resources: includes documentation and over 6 ½ hours of online training, also included.

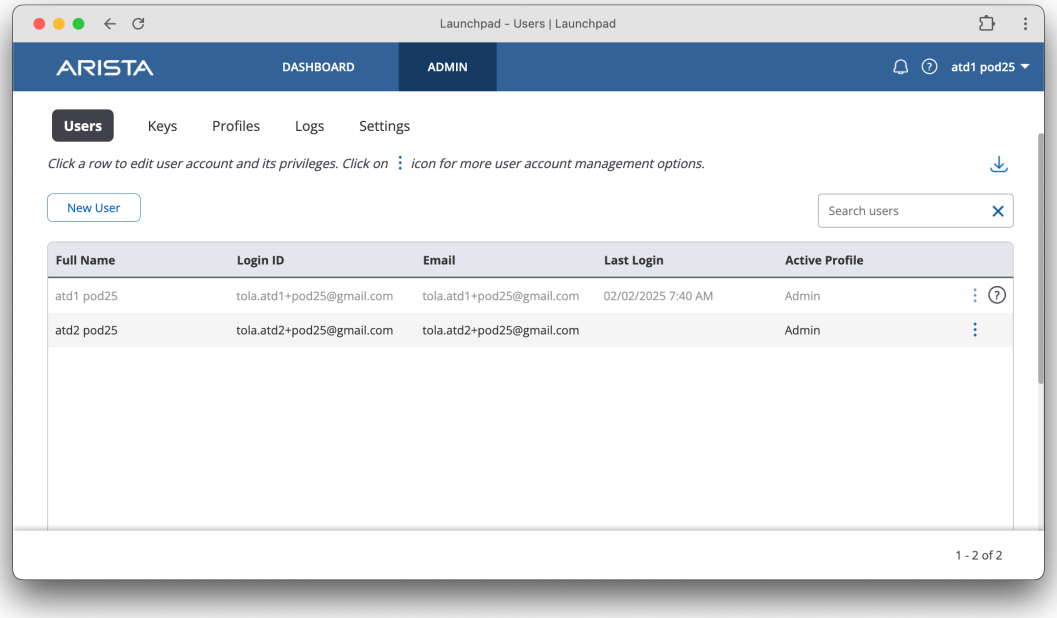
Wi-Fi Device Registration: application for importing APs into your account

CVP Staging (CloudVision Portal): switch management and staging environment

AGNI: Network Access Control

Add a User and Assign Privileges

1. First, use the Admin menu to add a user.
2. Select the `Admin` tab at the top of the Launchpad window:



3. Overview of Launchpad Admin menu:
    a. **Users** - Assign Access to users with different access levels as well as to specific folders
    b. **Keys** - Used with API integrations
    c. **Profiles** - Defines Access levels to CV-CUE, LaunchPad, and Guest Manager
    d. **Logs** - Download User Action Logs
    e. **Settings** - Lockout Policy, Password Policy, and 2-Factor settings

> **Authentication**
>
> CloudVision CUE authenticates users via SAML directory integration or via the Launchpad identity providers. These can be customized with local users in Launchpad or directory single-sign-on users. For more information, see Integrating Third-Party SAML Authentication Providers on Arista Communities.

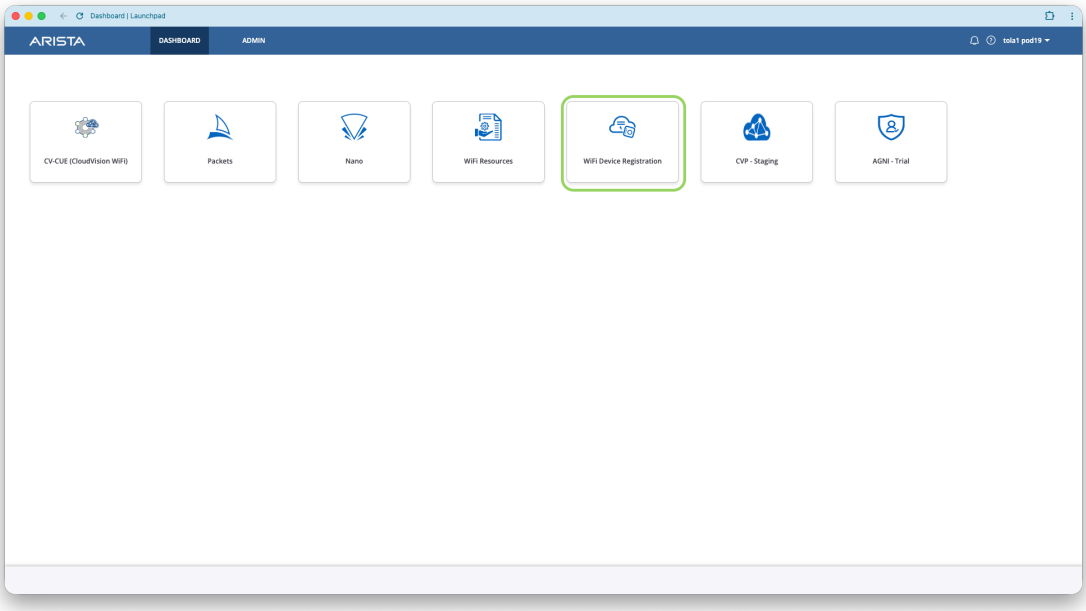
AP Registration

Reference Information

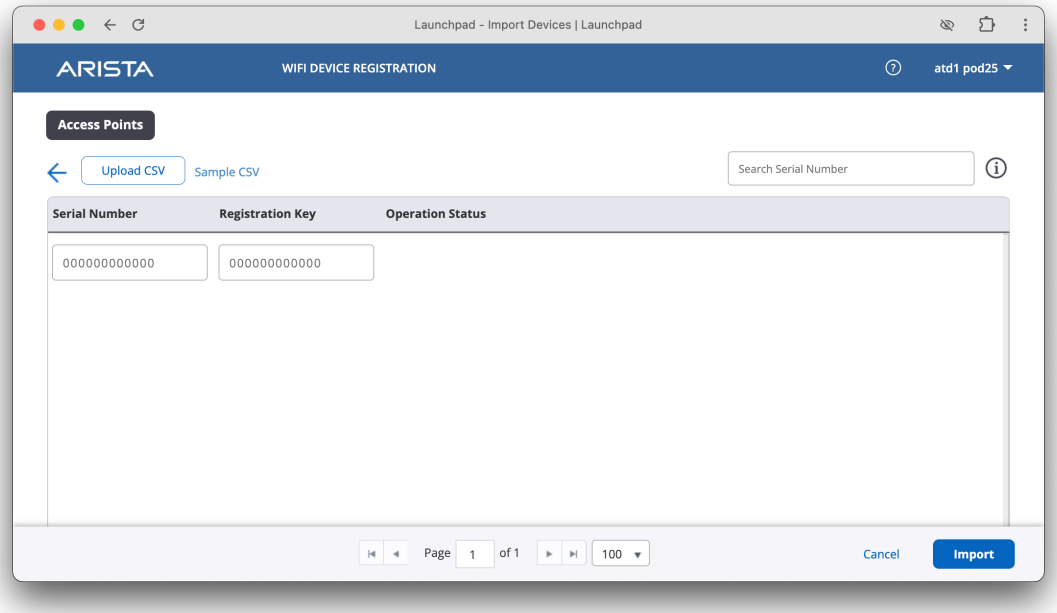
For this lab, these steps have already been done for you by event staff.

Arista AP serial numbers are automatically assigned to the user's CV-CUE staging area when purchased. In addition, specific devices can be registered for management using the `WiFi Device Registration` function, accessible from `Launchpad Dashboard`.

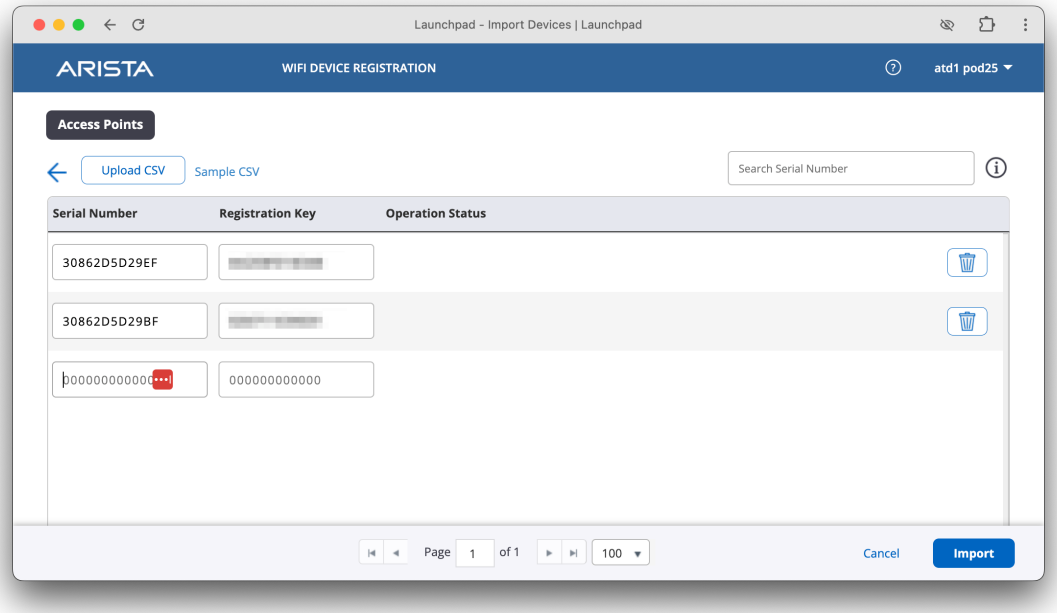
1. Let's select the `Dashboard` menu option on the left-hand side of the screen. This opens the `Dashboard Overview` screen which provides us with numerous metrics for our wireless environment.



2. Within the `Import` function you can provide individual AP serials and keys or upload a CSV.



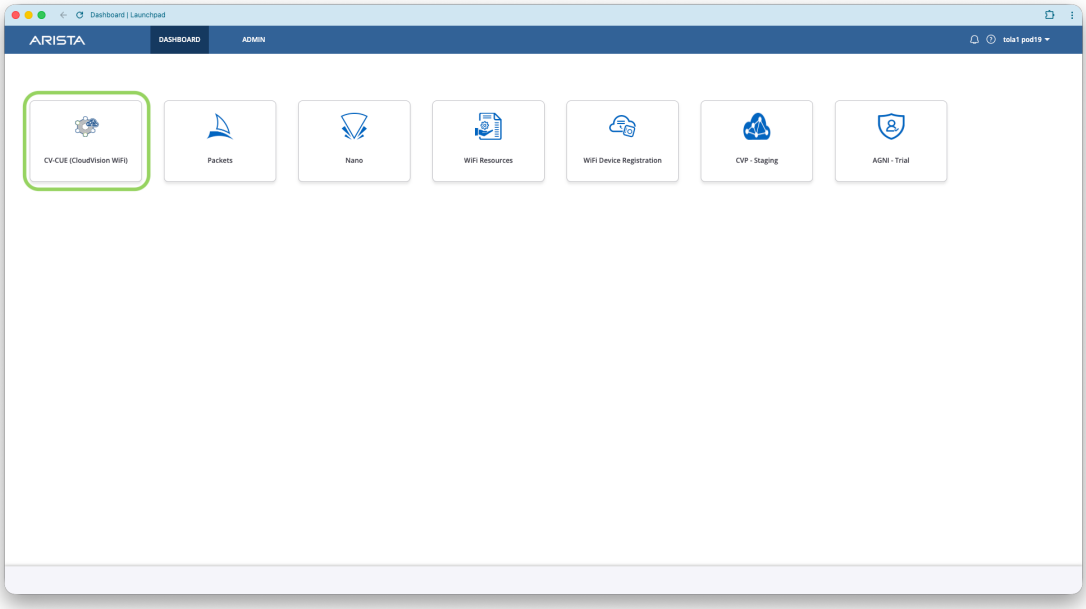
3. Assign Access points to Wireless Manager Service



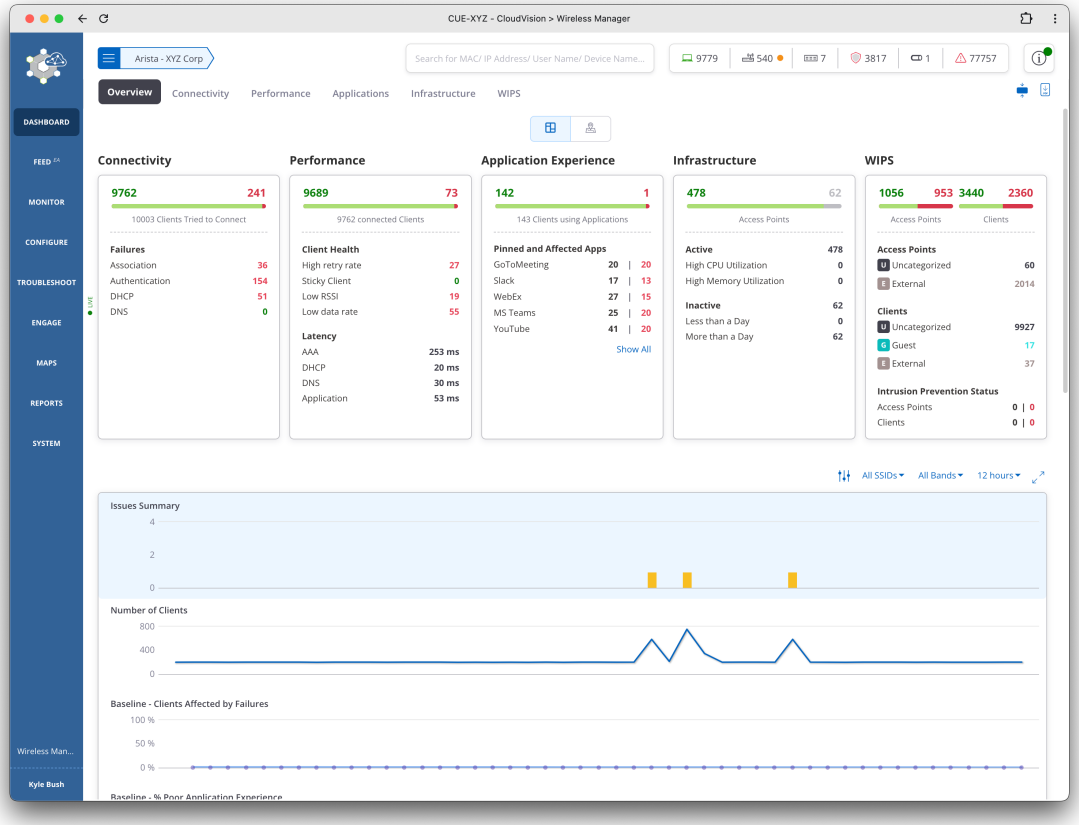
CV-CUE CloudVision Wi-Fi Access

CloudVision CUE - Cognitive Unified Edge, provides the management plane and monitoring functions for the Arista Wi-Fi solution.

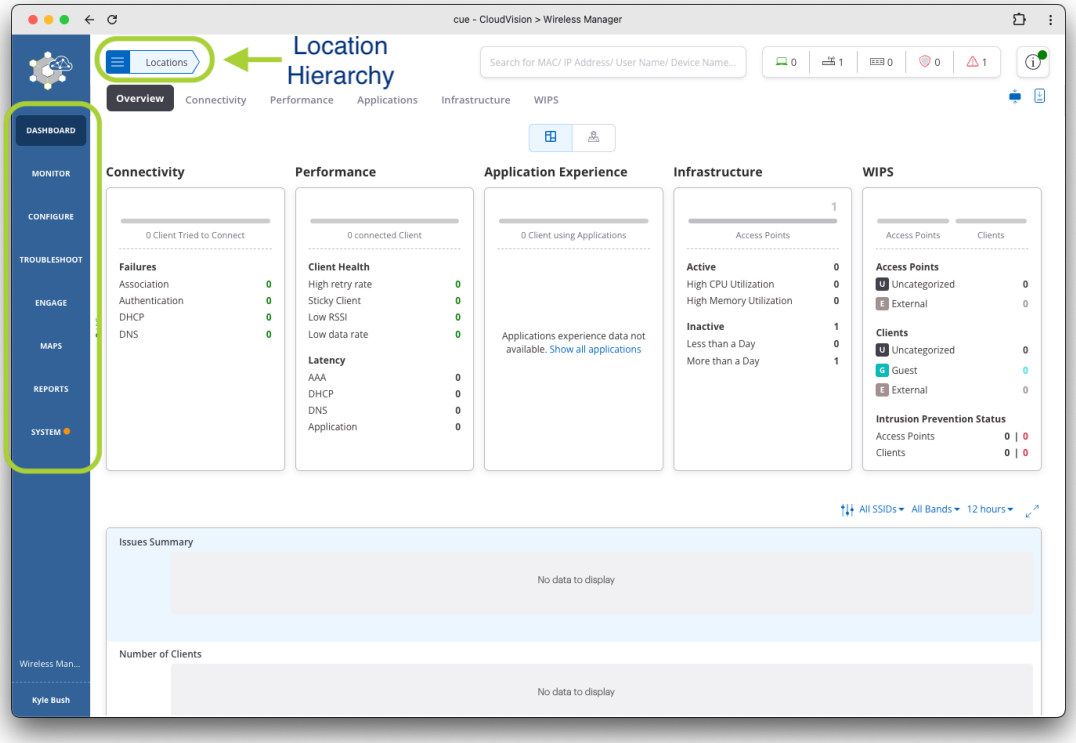
1. Select the `CV-CUE (CloudVision WiFi)` tile in the LaunchPad from the `Dashboard` menu.



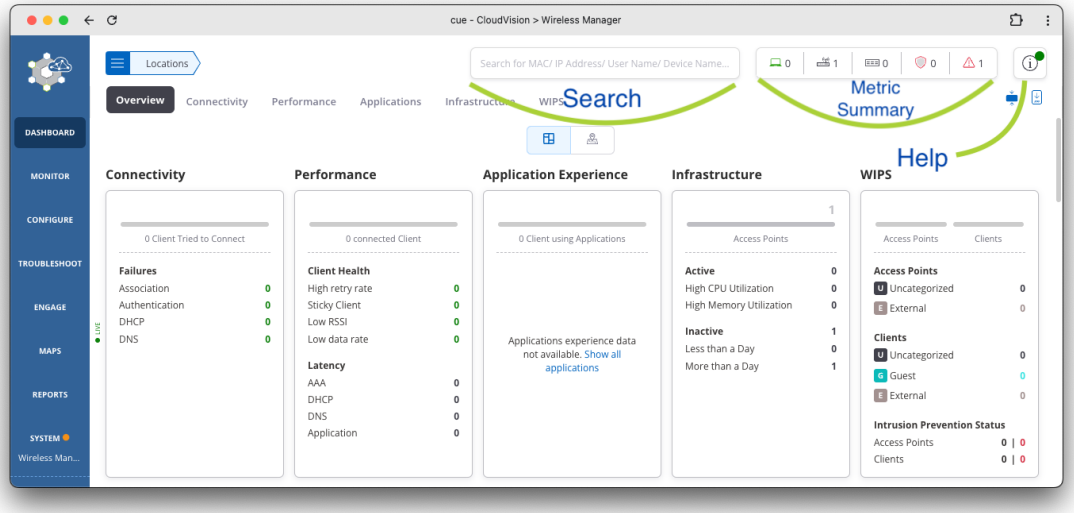
2. When the CV-CUE interface launches, you are presented with an initial dashboard to monitor your wireless environment at a glance. We will revisit these metrics later in the lab. Since this is a new setup, the initial dashboard screen will be mostly empty.



3. Use the left menu bar to select monitoring and configuration functions.



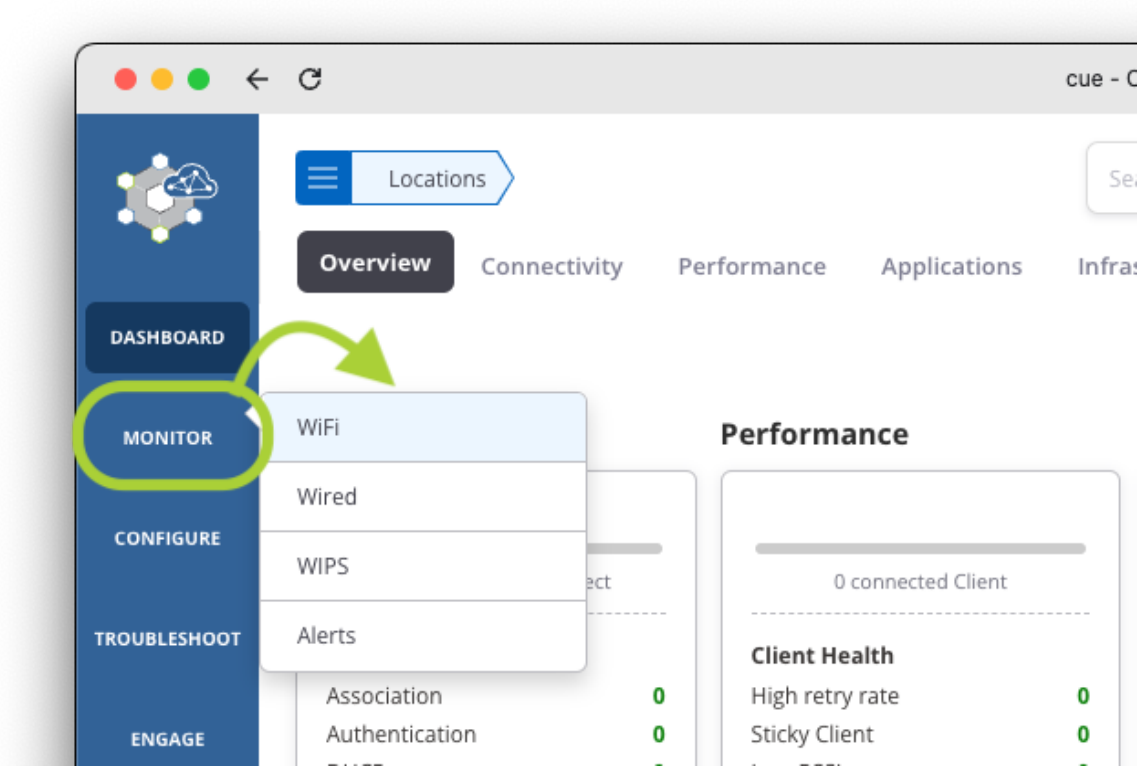
4. The primary menu navigation functions are the following:
    a. **Dashboard** - Alerts, Client Access, Infrastructure health, Application Experience, and WIPS
    b. **Monitor** - Monitor and explore Clients, APs, Radios, SSIDs, Application traffic, Tunnels
    c. **Configure** - Wi-Fi SSIDs, APs and Radios, Tunnels, RADIUS, and WIPS settings
    d. **Troubleshoot** - Client connection test, packet trace, live debug logs, historic logging
    e. **Engage** - User insights, Presence, Usage, 3rd party integrations
    f. **Floor Plans** - Floor layouts and AP location map view
    g. **Reports** - Detailed information for Infrastructure APs/Radios, Client Connectivity and Experience, WIPS detections
    h. **System** - Locations Hierarchy, AP Groups, 3rd party server settings, keys and certificates
5. In addition to the menu bar navigation and Locations Hierarchy, the UI provides a common Search bar, Metric summary, and Help button throughout workflows.



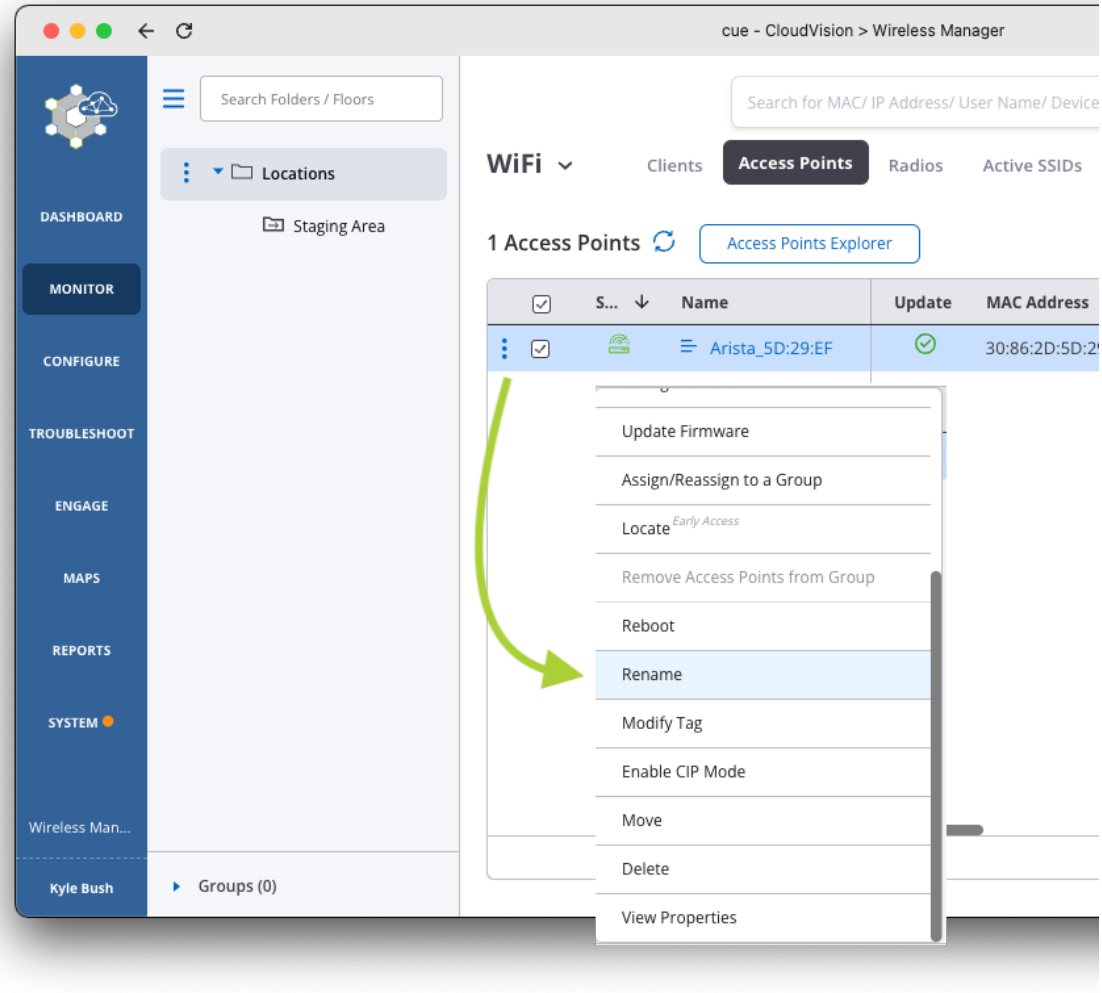
Assign AP Name

Access points that successfully receive an IP address, DNS, and default gateway via DHCP will have a solid green power light.

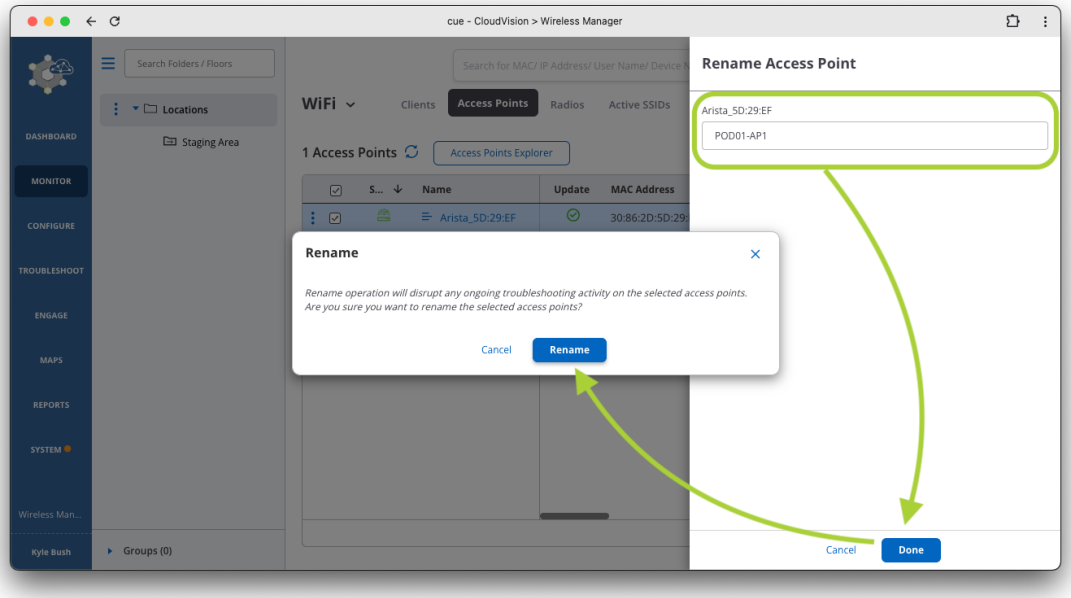
1. Using the left navigation bar in CV-CUE, navigate to `Monitor > WiFi`.

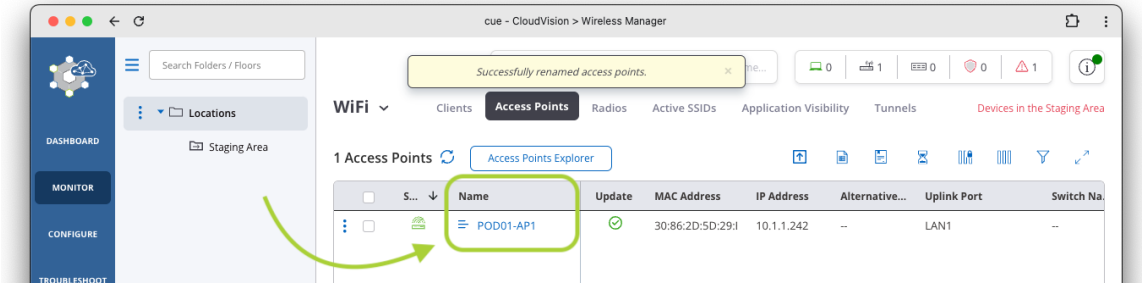


2. Select the `Access Points` section and observe the discovered AP and default name `Arista_` and the last 3 bytes of the MAC address.
3. Customize the AP's name by selecting the 3-dots menu and Rename



4. Give the AP a name such as: `POD##-AP1` or `POD##-AP2` where ## is a 2 digit character between 01-12 that was assigned to your lab/Pod.



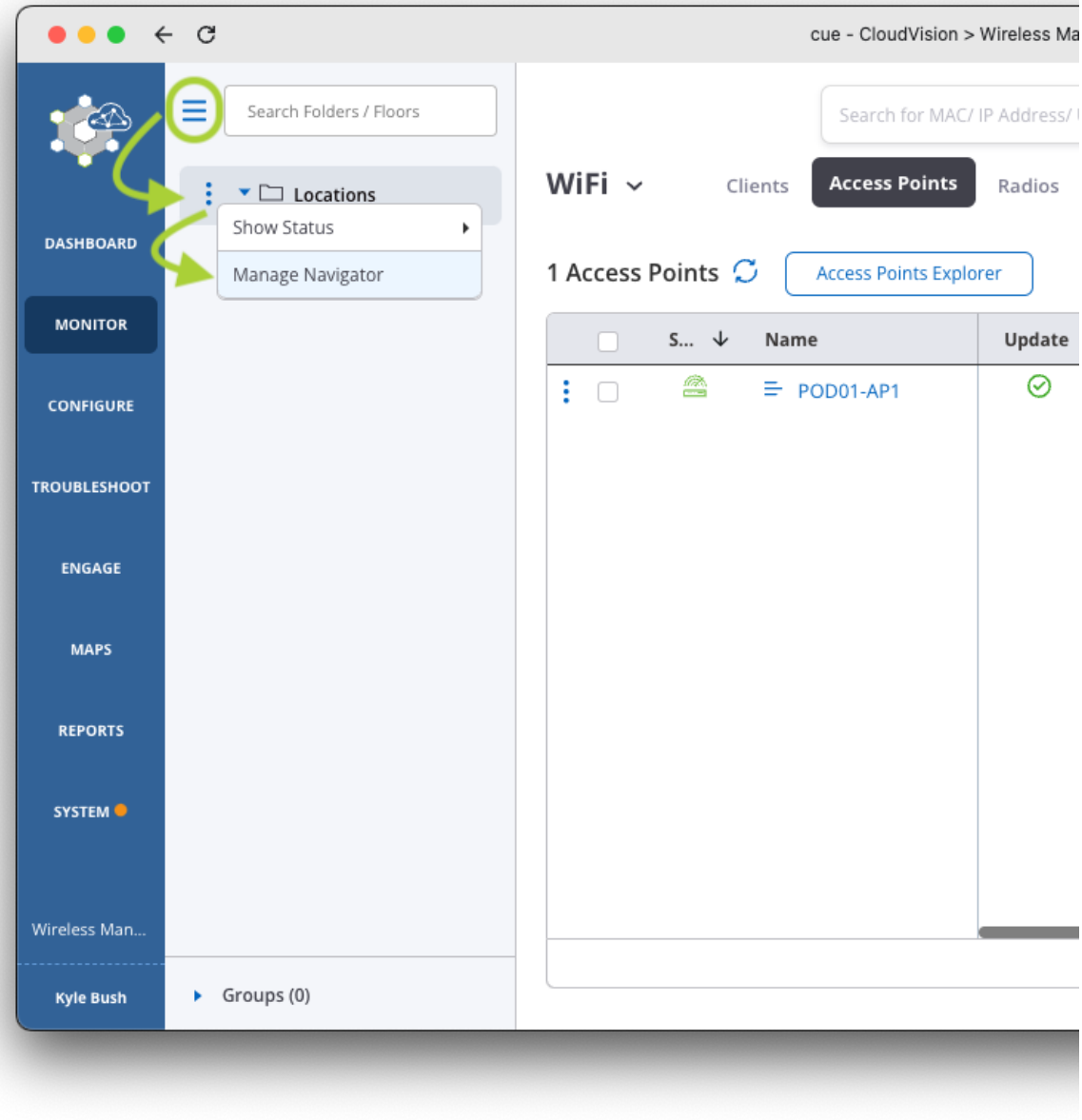


Managing the Configuration Hierarchy

Within CV-CUE, much of the configuration is hierarchical, so everything you configure will be inherited from that level and its children.

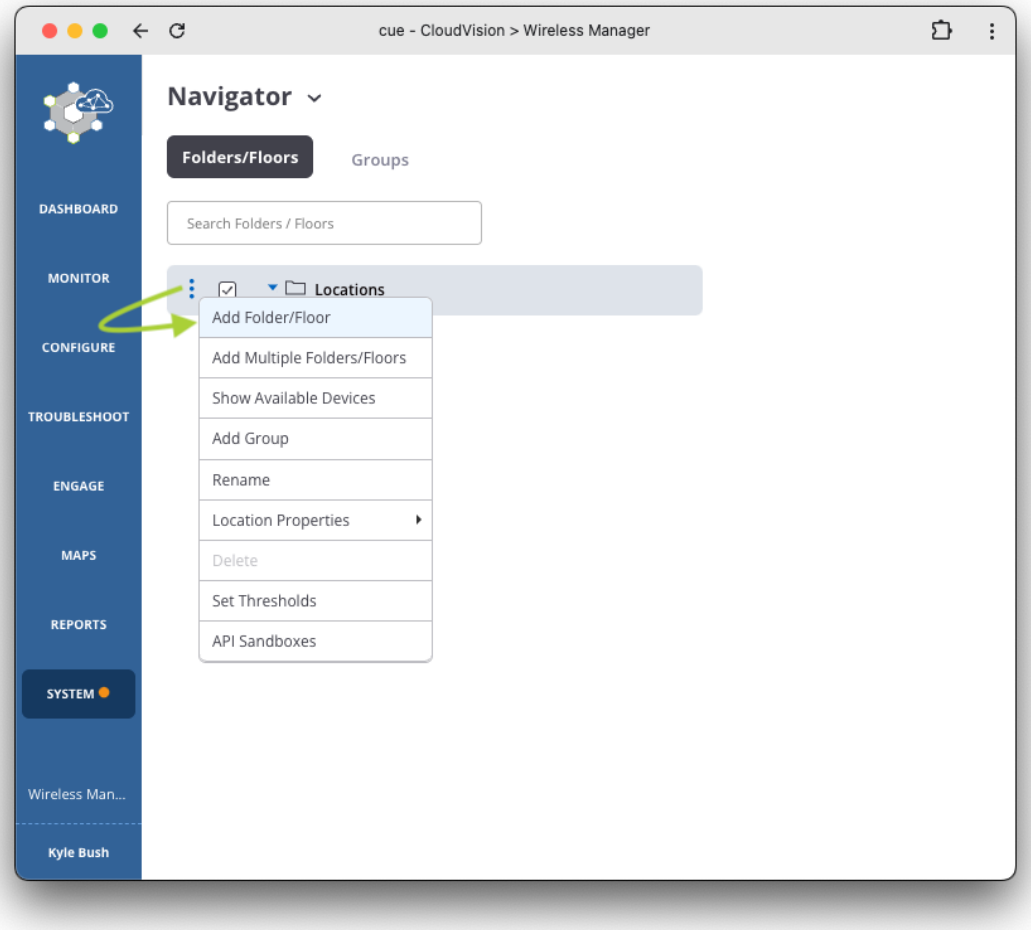
Moving AP to Location

Expand the `Locations` pane by selecting the hamburger icon ☰. Next, select the three dots ••• to the left of `Locations` and select `Manage Navigator`.



1. `Manage Navigator` is where you create Folders, Floors, and Groups.
    a. **Folders** typically represent a company, branch office name or division.
    b. **Floors** are straightforward and are where maps are placed.
    c. **Groups** are a way to make a configuration more granular. Let's say you want a branch location to have all of the same configuration but Outdoor APs need to vary from that. You would create a group for the Outdoor APs, put the APs into that group and override the part of the configuration that is unique. Think of your company and how you would want to lay it out.
2. Add a `Folder` for your Company Name. In the `Navigator`, select the 3 dots ••• next to

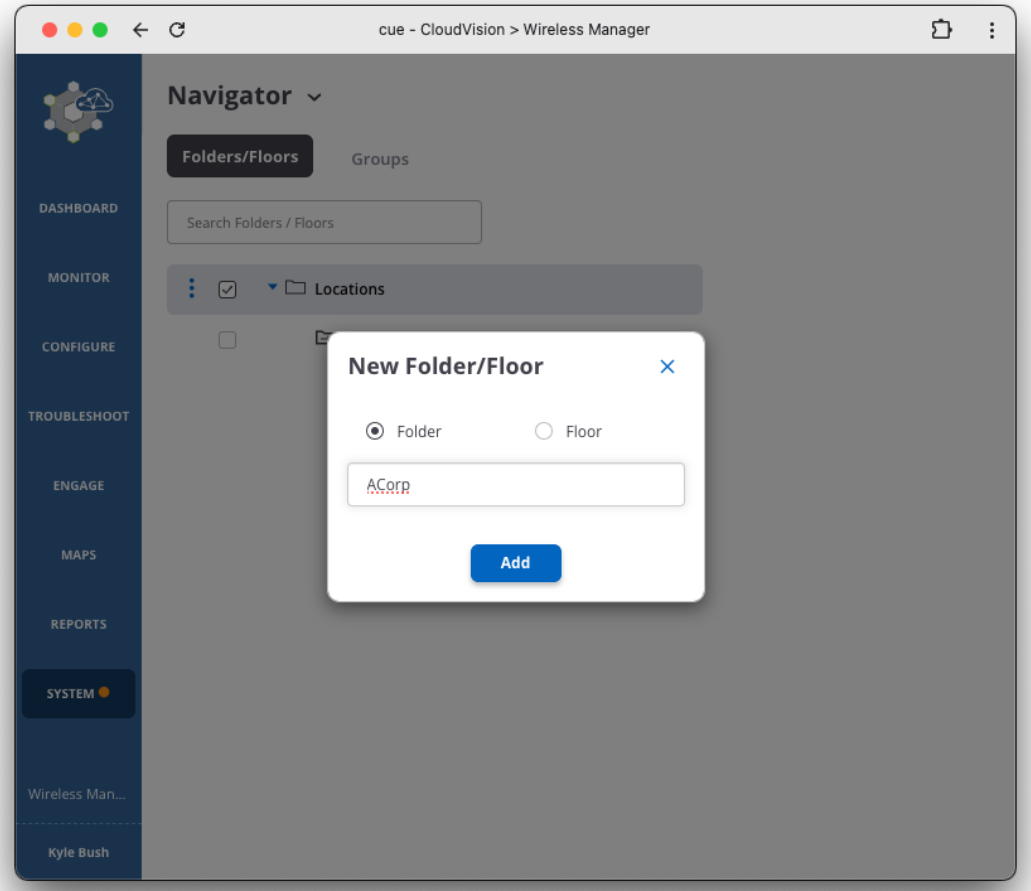
`Locations`. Select `Add Folder/Floor`



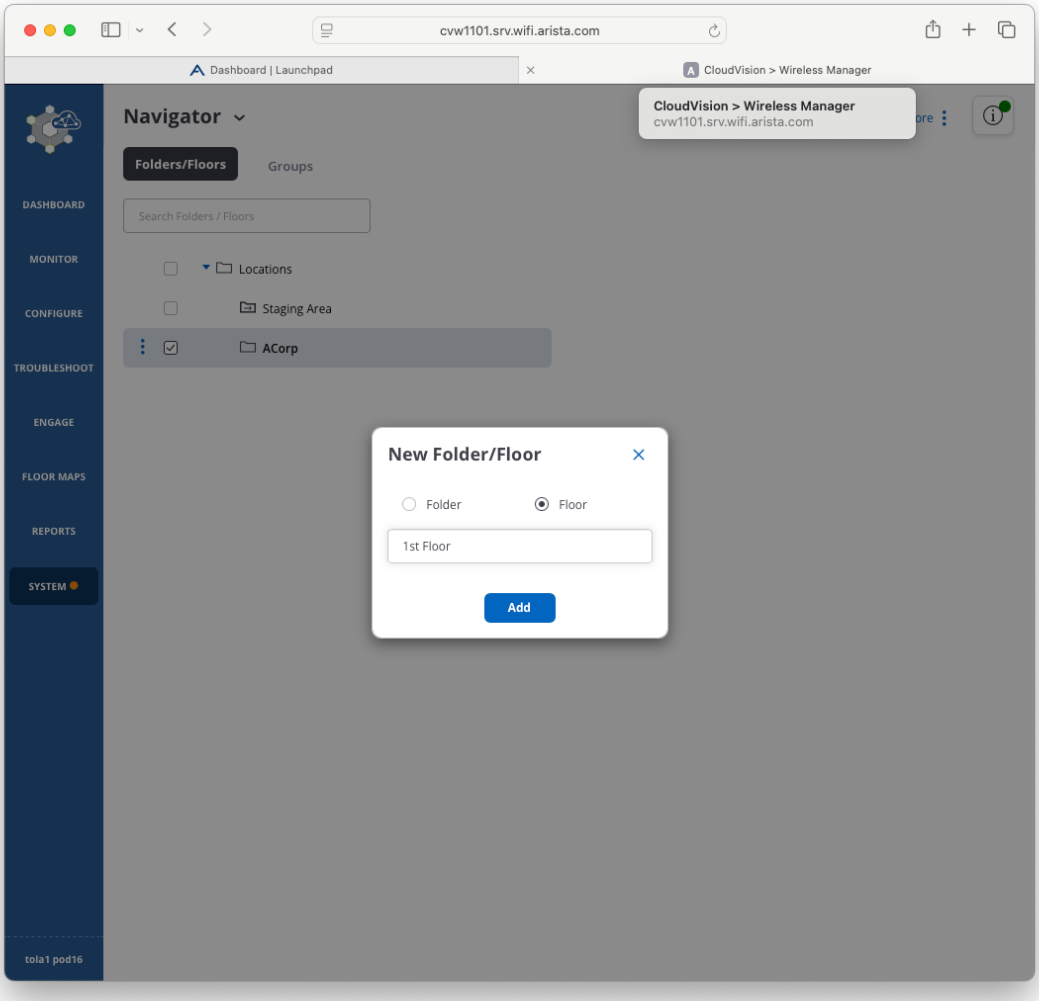
3. Add a new folder using the names below, depending on your student assignment

Folder Name

Student	Folder Name
Student 1	`ACorp`
Student 2	`BCorp`

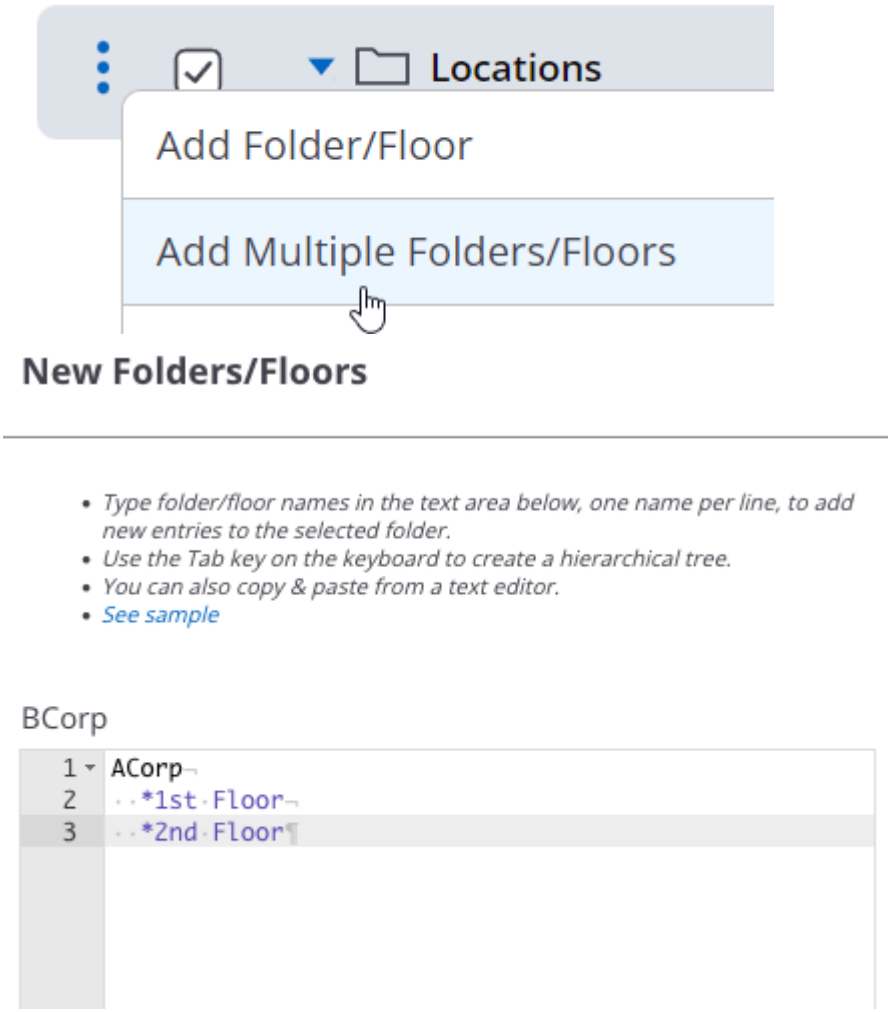


4. Next, create a `Floor` called `1st Floor`. Select the word `A/BCorp` to expose the 3 dots menu, and select `Add Folder/Floor`.


cvw1101.srv.wifi.arista.com
Dashboard | Launchpad
CloudVision > Wireless Manager
CloudVision > Wireless Manager
cvw1101.srv.wifi.arista.com
Navigator
Folders/Floors
Groups
Search Folders / Floors
Locations
Staging Area
ACorp
DASHBOARD
MONITOR
CONFIGURE
TROUBLESHOOT
ENGAGE
FLOOR MAPS
REPORTS
SYSTEM
tola1 pod16
New Folder/Floor
Folder
Floor
1st Floor
Add

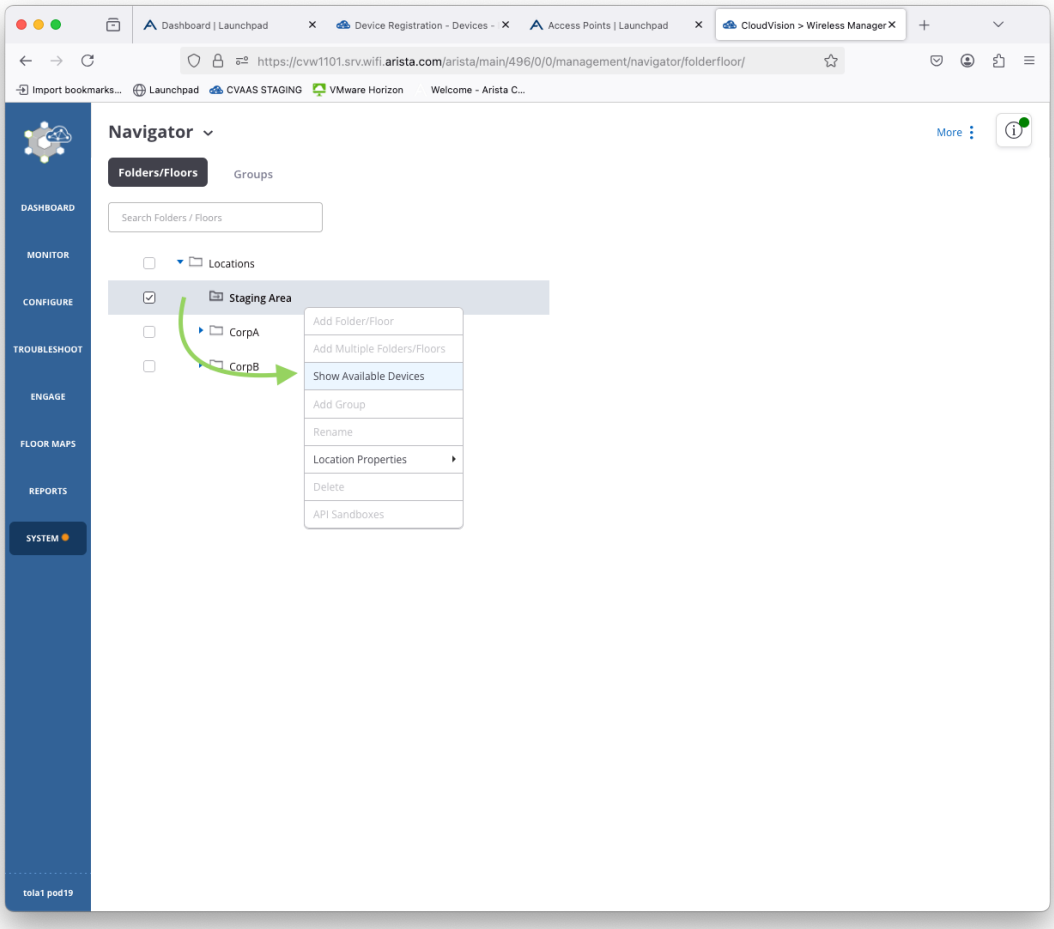
Add Multiple Floors

It's also possible to add multiple floors at once using the `Add Multiple Folders/Floors` menu option



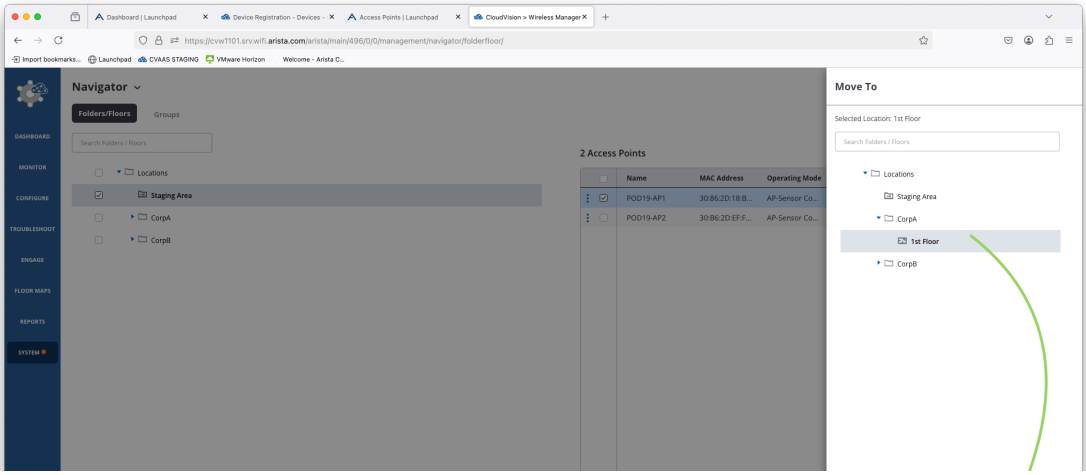
Use the `*` key to create floors instead of folders

5. Next, move your AP into the `1st Floor` you created. To move your AP from the staging area, right-click the `Staging Area` folder and select `Show Available Devices`.



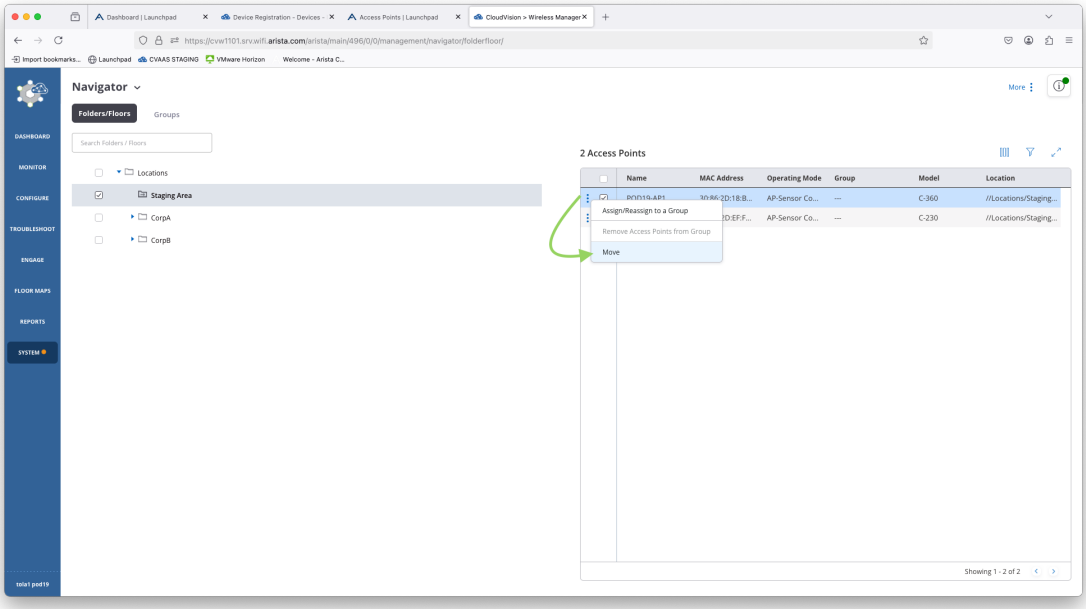
6. Next, right click on the AP name, select `Move` and then select the `1st Floor` folder you created earlier, and then select the `Move` button at the bottom of the screen.

Step 1: AP Move

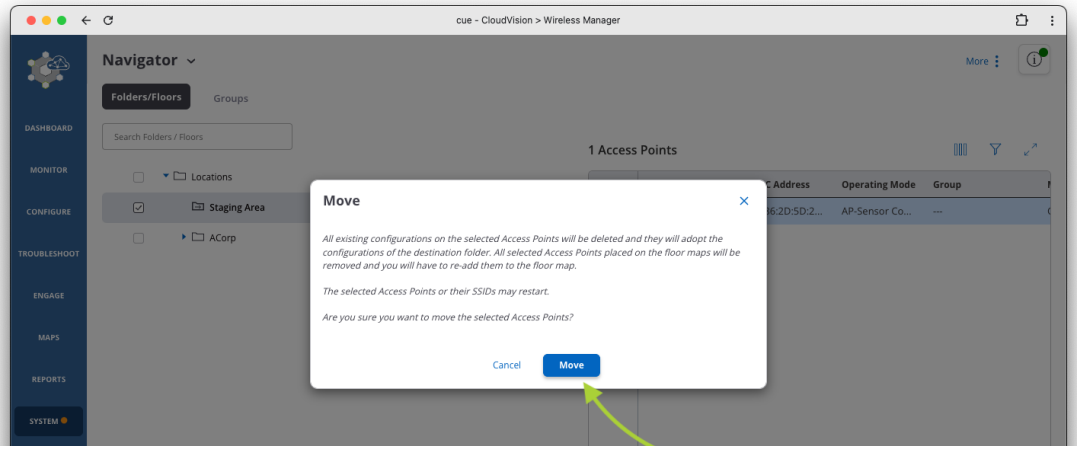




Step 2: AP Move

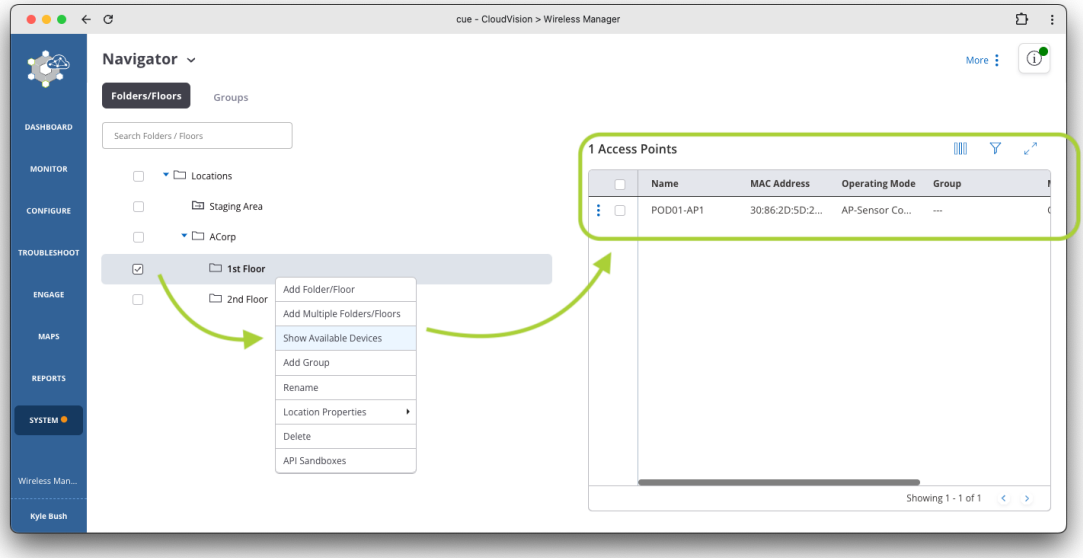


Step 3: AP Move





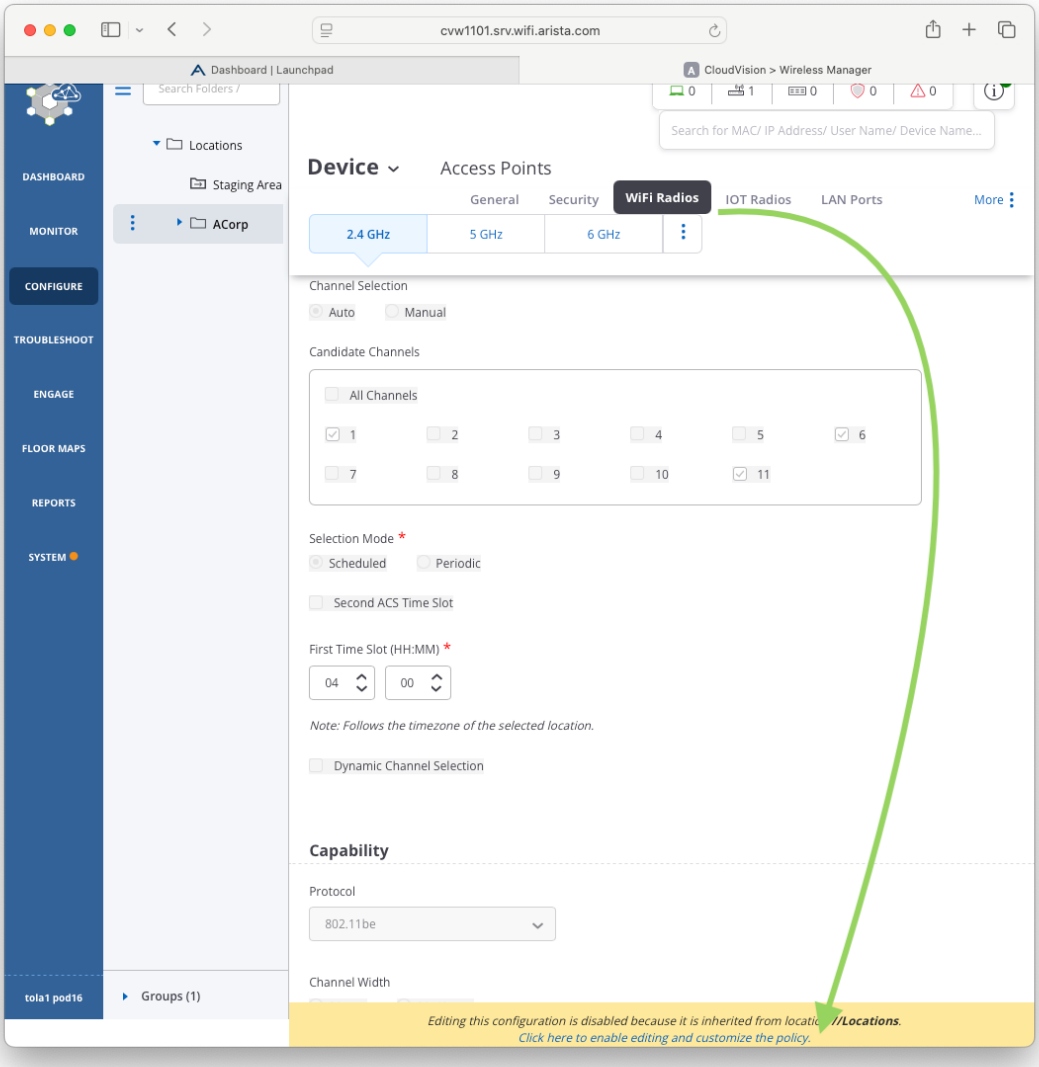
7. You'll see a pop-up message to confirm the move. Select `Move` again to finish the process
8. You can verify the move by selecting the `1st Floor` folder and then `Show Available Devices`.



Adjusting Power/Channels

For this workshop event, we will be reducing Wi-Fi Radio channel width and transmit power levels to avoid interference with the hosting facility.

1. To customize these power settings: Navigate to the `Configure > Device > Access Points` menu
2. Once in that menu, ensure that `ACorp` or `BCorp` is selected from the tree structure on the left. If you do not see the tree structure, select the hamburger icon next to `Locations` in the top left to expose the tree.
3. You'll notice all the menus are grayed out. Select the link at the bottom of the screen to unlock editing. Then select `Continue` to customize the configuration.



Customize Configuration

If the policy is customized at the selected folder, it will no longer inherit any policy changes from the parent folder. Are you sure you want to customize the policy at the selected folder?

What does this mean?

Access points or the SSIDs on these access points may restart.

Are you sure you want to continue?

Cancel **Continue**

4. Use the table below to set the following parameters under the `WiFi Radios` tab and `5GHz` (you can ignore 2.4GHz) and you will override the following:
    - Channel Selection: Select `Manual` and see the "Channel Settings" table below.
    - Channel Width: `20MHz`
    - Transmit Power: `Manual` to `4 dBm`

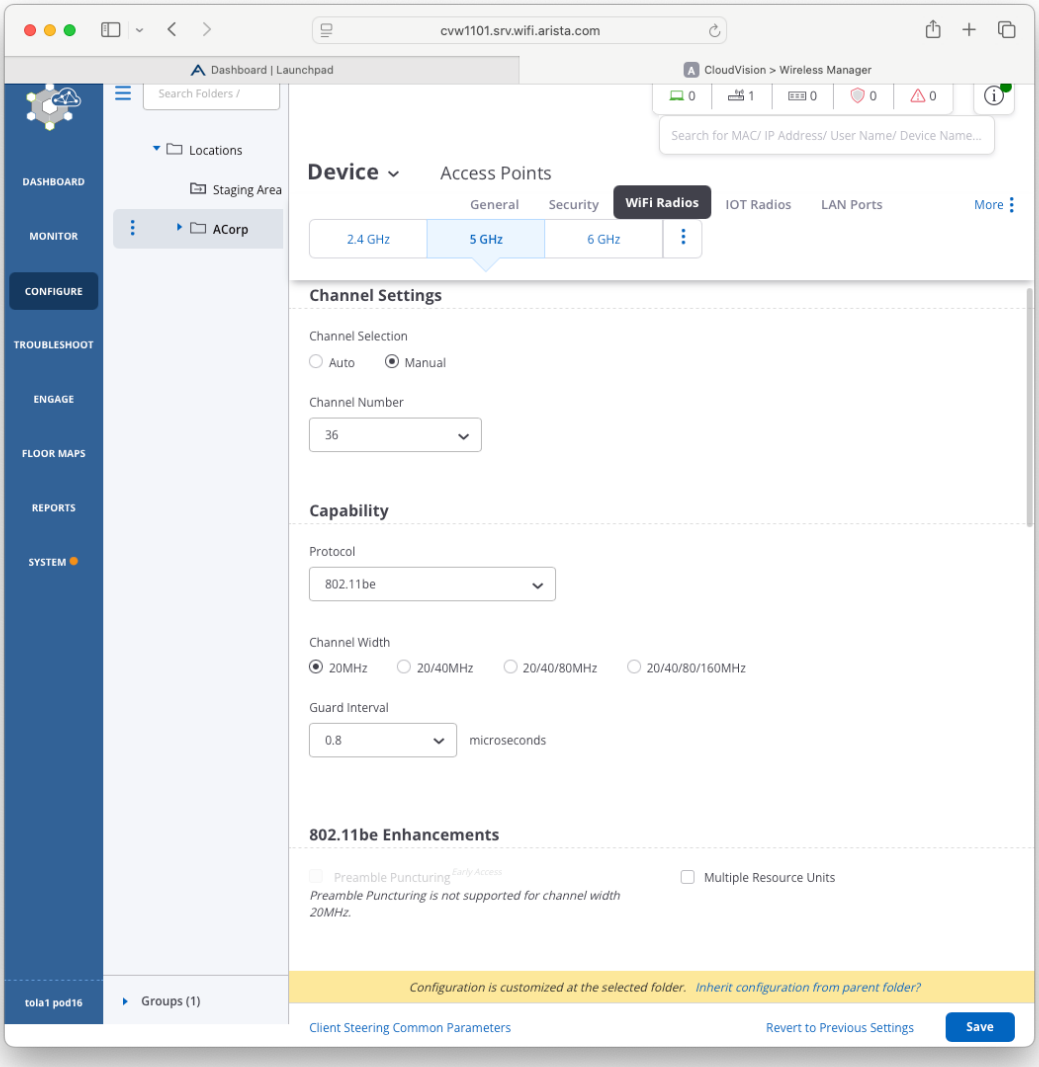
    > **My settings are greyed out**
    >
    > At the bottom of your screen you may need to select the link to override the inheritance policy. It should state: `Click here to enable editing and customize the policy`.

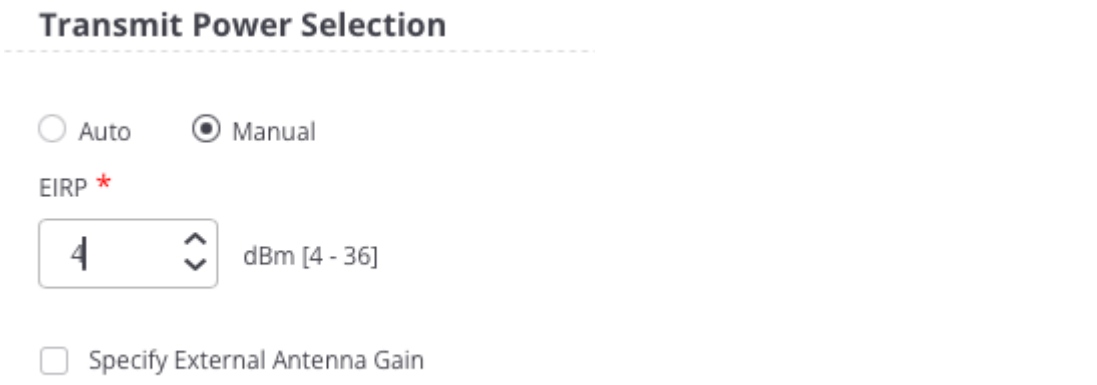
    Find your pod number and assigned student number, set the `Candidate Channel`

All Channel Settings

Pod	Student	2.4 GHz	5 GHz	Channel Width	Trans Pow
01	1	Disabled	36	20MHz	4 dB
01	2	Disabled	40	20MHz	4 dB
02	1	Disabled	44	20MHz	4 dB
02	2	Disabled	48	20MHz	4 dB
03	1	Disabled	52	20MHz	4 dB
03	2	Disabled	56	20MHz	4 dB
04	1	Disabled	60	20MHz	4 dB
04	2	Disabled	64	20MHz	4 dB
05	1	Disabled	100	20MHz	4 dB
05	2	Disabled	104	20MHz	4 dB
06	1	Disabled	108	20MHz	4 dB
06	2	Disabled	112	20MHz	4 dB
07	1	Disabled	120	20MHz	4 dB
07	2	Disabled	124	20MHz	4 dB
08	1	Disabled	128	20MHz	4 dB
08	2	Disabled	132	20MHz	4 dB

Pod	Student	2.4 GHz	5 GHz	Channel Width	Trans Pow
09	1	Disabled	136	20MHz	4 dB
09	2	Disabled	140	20MHz	4 dB
10	1	Disabled	144	20MHz	4 dB
10	2	Disabled	149	20MHz	4 dB
11	1	Disabled	153	20MHz	4 dB
11	2	Disabled	157	20MHz	4 dB
12	1	Disabled	161	20MHz	4 dB
12	2	Disabled	165	20MHz	4 dB





5. Select `Save` at the bottom of the page then select `Continue` to confirm.

6. Select `Continue` to commit changes

Assign Floor Plan

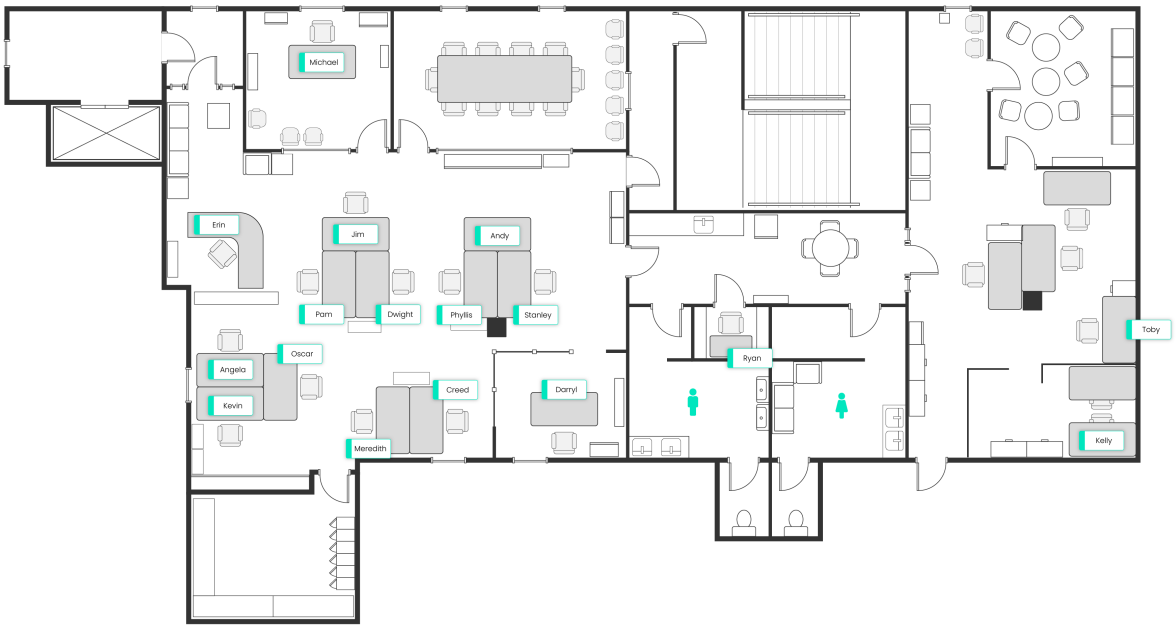
Let's assign a floor plan to our `1st Floor` for our respective corporation. Depending on the lab guide format, you can either save the image here or download from the email. We are going to use this image and import it into CV-CUE.

Download MkDocs Site

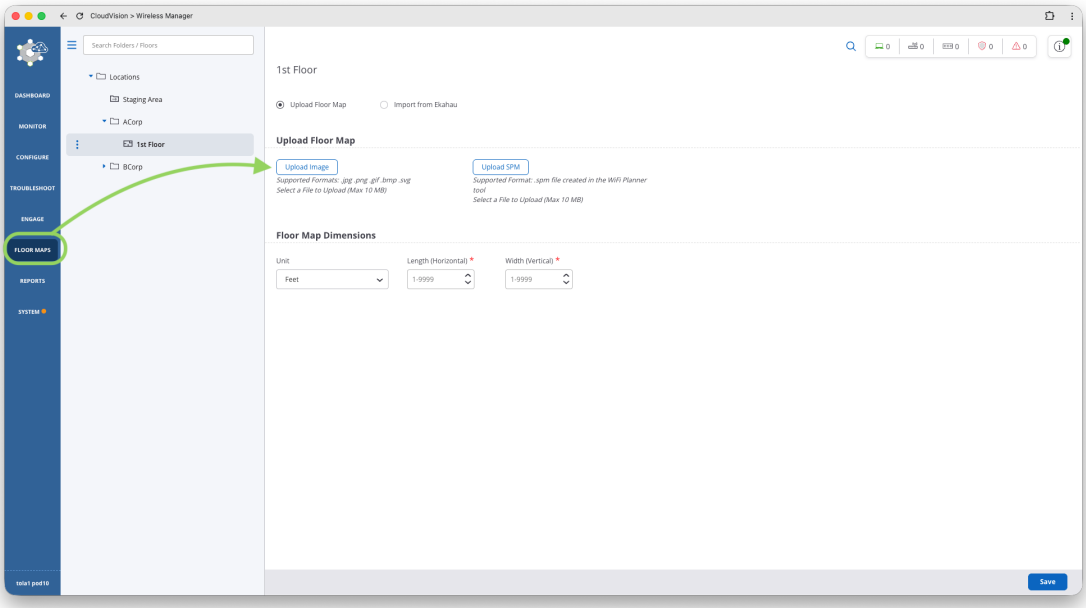
If you are viewing this guide as a MkDocs site, simply right-click the image below and `Save Image As` to your Desktop.

PDF Emailed Floor Plan

If you are viewing this as a PDF, check the email you received as part of this Arista Test Drive session. You will find an image attached to the email to use as a floor plan. Save that image to your computer



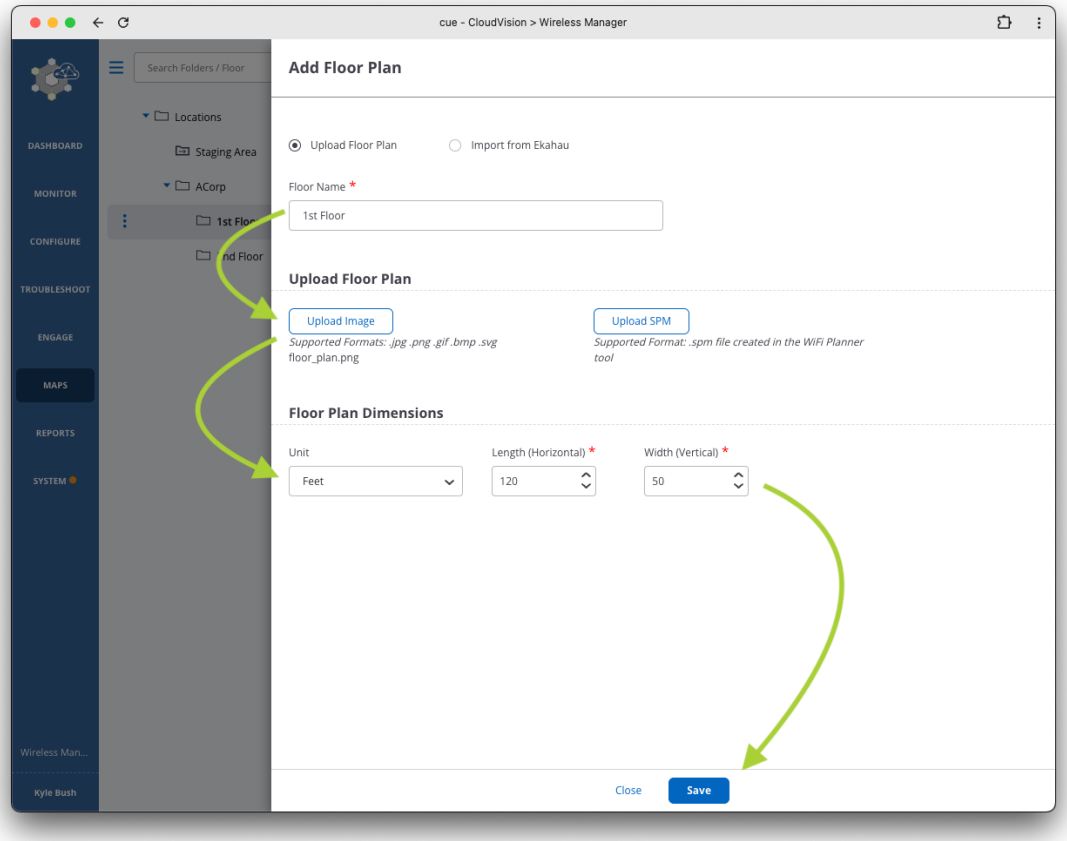
1. In the left hand menu, select `Floor Maps`. Make sure to set the location level to be `CorpA/B - 1st Floor`. Then select the `Upload Image` button to import the floor plan image.



2. Input the following dimensions and select `Save`.

Floor Plan Settings

Key	Value
Unit	Feet
Length	120
Width	50



3. Next, drag the AP onto the map, from the right-hand side menu, to see how easy placing APs is. Choose `Place Access Points`.

I don't see my AP?

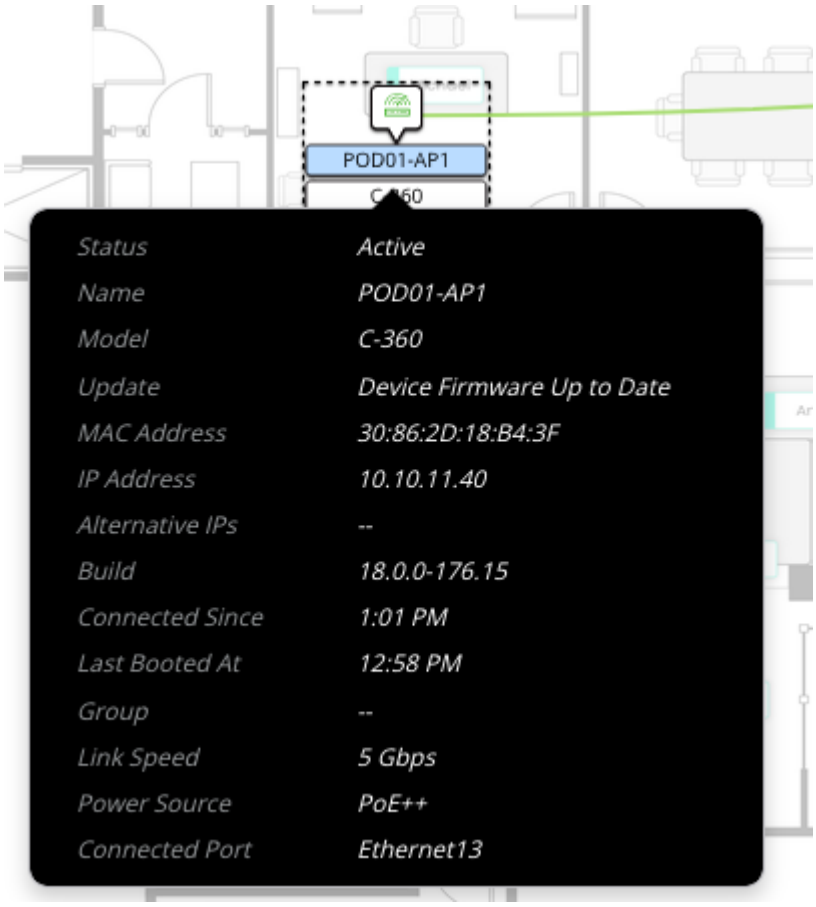
If you do not see an AP, it is because your AP is assigned to another location (folder) and you'll need to move it to the `1st Floor` folder (see steps above). Or, you may have the incorrect menu selected in the upper right hand corner of the screen.

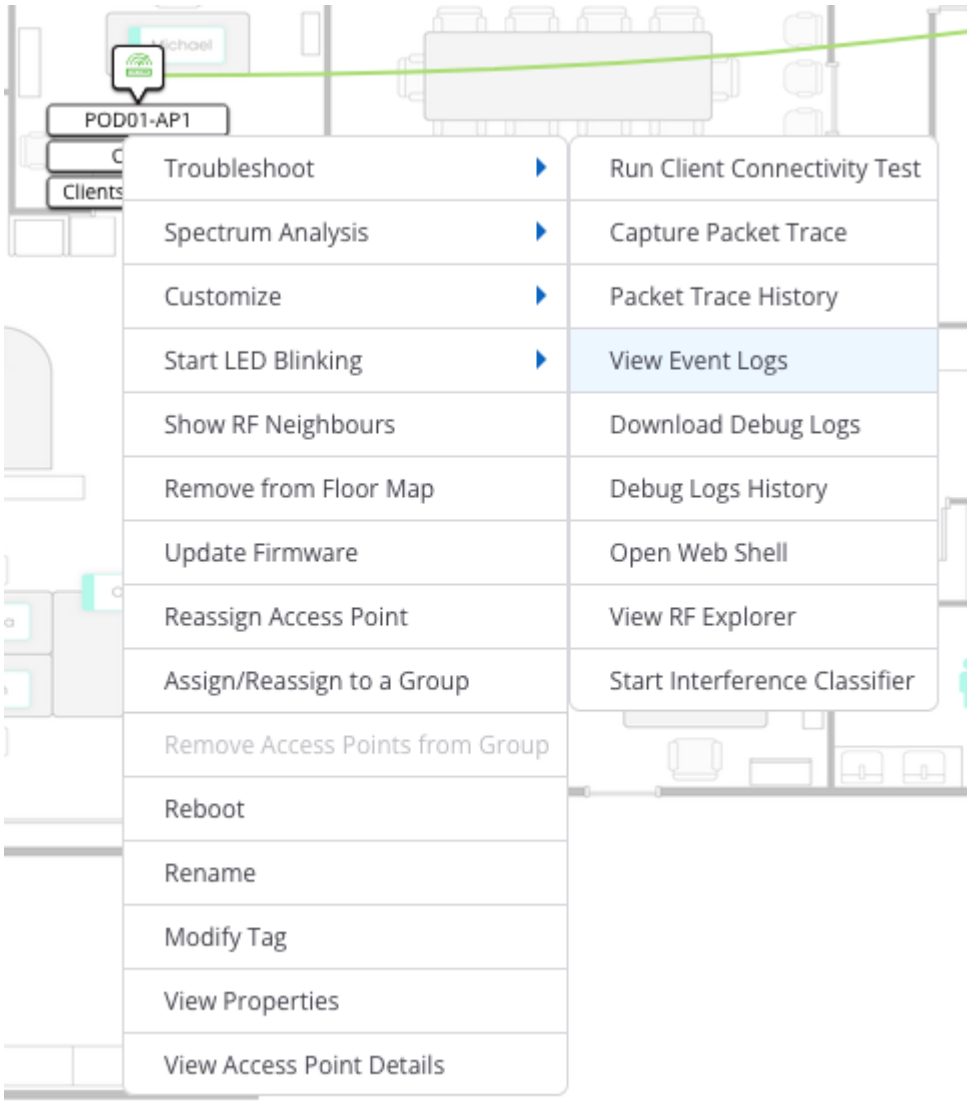

DASHBOARD
MONITOR
CONFIGURE
TROUBLESHOOT
ENGAGE
MAPS
REPORTS
SYSTEM
Staging Area
ACorp
1st Floor
1st Floor
2nd Floor
FEET
Drag and place access points on the floor plan
Search for MAC/ IP Address/ Device Name.
POD01-AP1

Screenshots

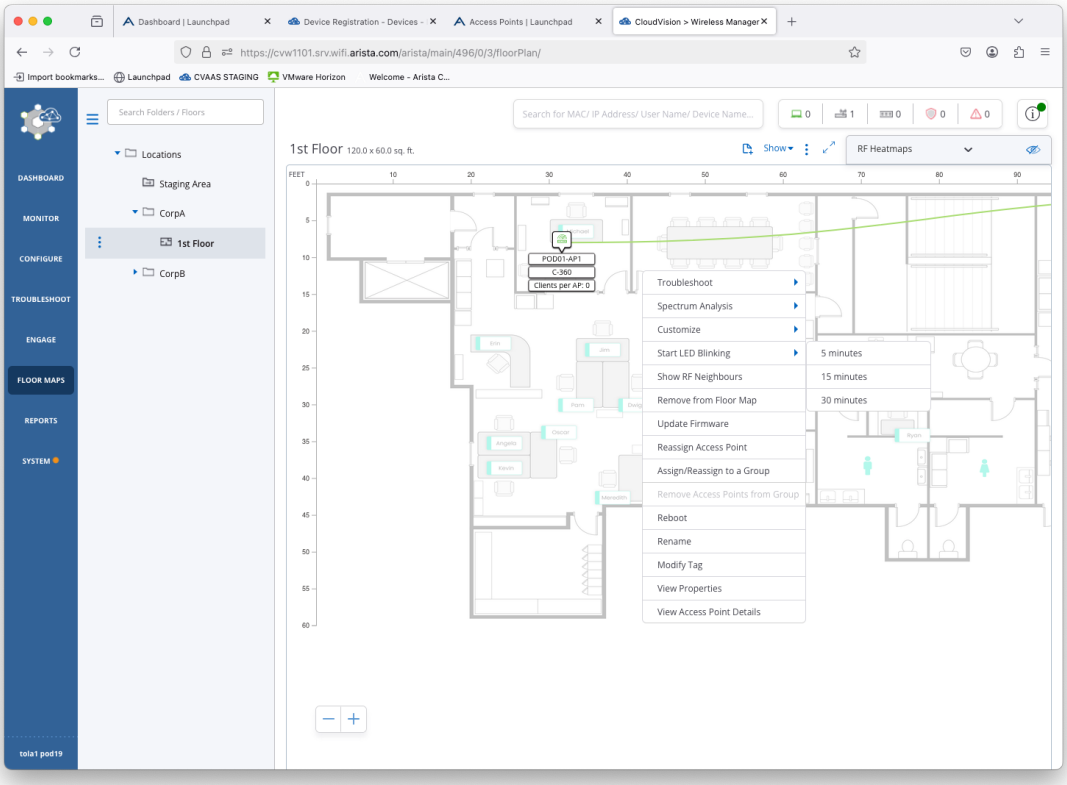


3. Hover over the AP image to get more information and then `right-click on the AP` image to see more options.


POD01-AP1
Status Active
Name POD01-AP1
Model C-360
Update Device Firmware Up to Date
MAC Address 30:86:2D:18:B4:3F
IP Address 10.10.11.40
Alternative IPs --
Build 18.0.0-176.15
Connected Since 1:01 PM
Last Booted At 12:58 PM
Group --
Link Speed 5 Gbps
Power Source PoE++
Connected Port Ethernet13



4. Next, explore the other menu options like `Start LED Blinking` (in the menu on the right-hand side of the screen).



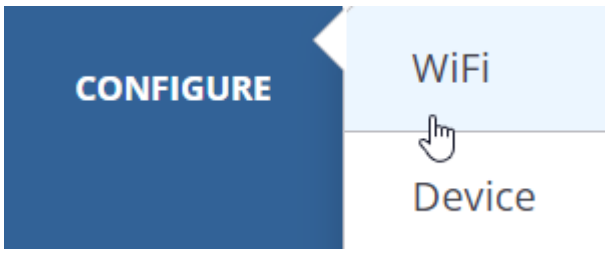
5. Try exploring the `Event Logs` under the `Troubleshoot` menu.

Creating a PSK SSID

The `Configure` section of CV-CUE is broken into several parts, including `WiFi`, `Device`, `Network Profiles`, `WIPS`, and `Alerts`.

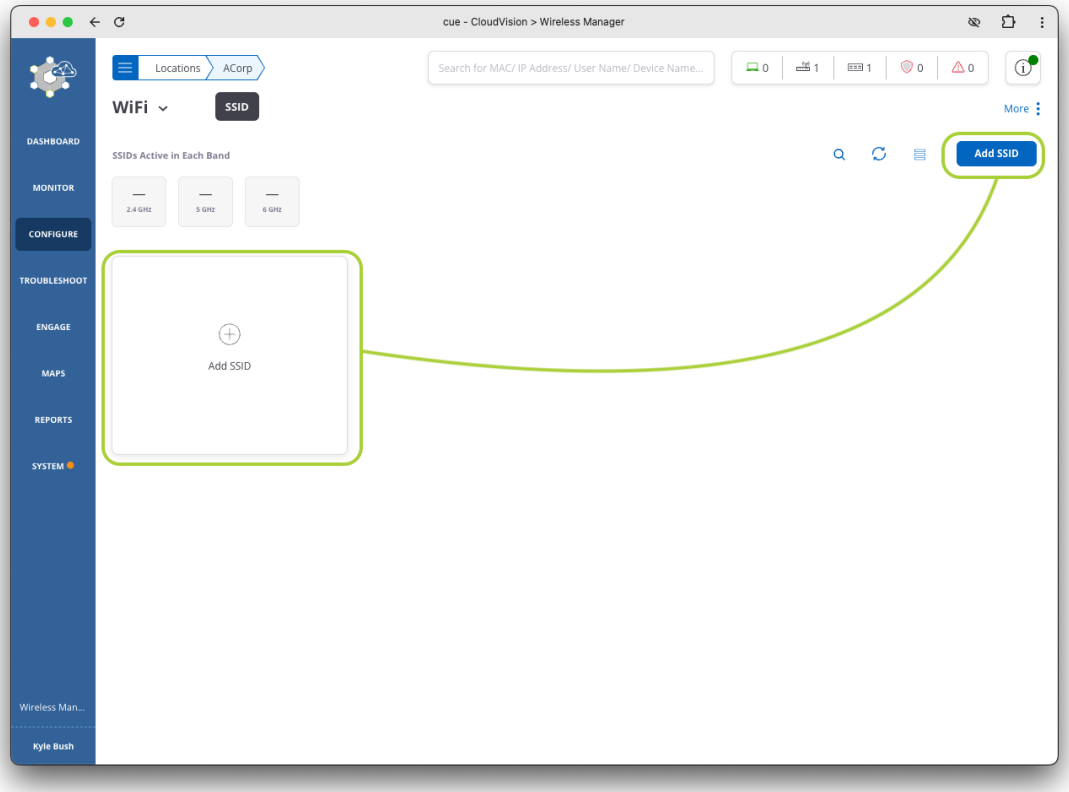
In this section of the lab, we will be working in the `WiFi` configuration area. We will create an SSID with a WPA2 PSK for your CorpA/B site.

1. Hover your cursor over the `Configure` menu option on the left side of the screen, then select `WiFi`.

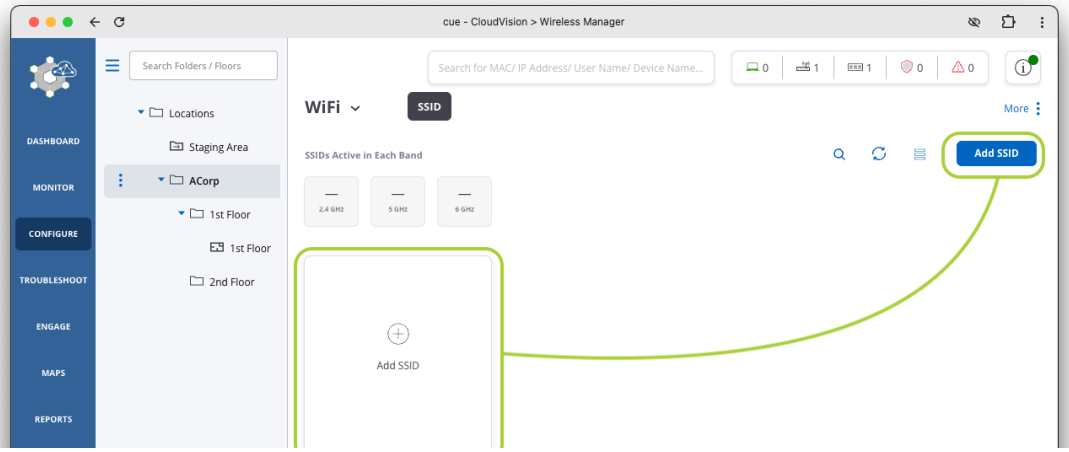


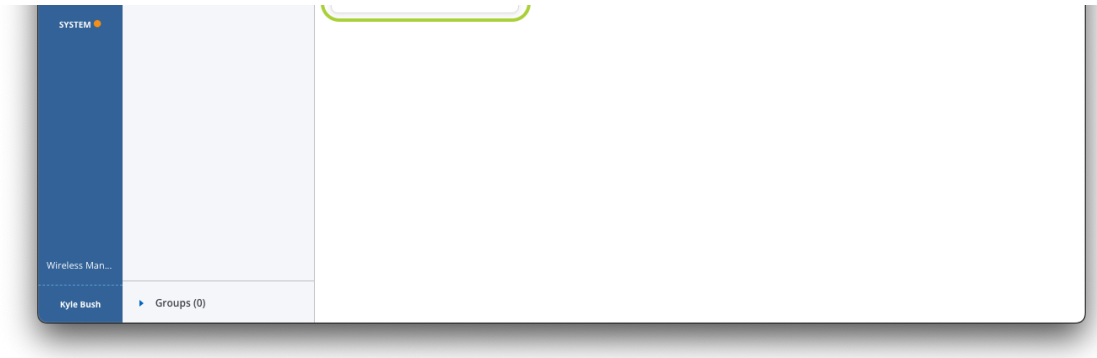
2. At the top of the screen, you will see where you are in the location hierarchy. Select the three lines ☰ next to `Locations` to expand the hierarchy and choose/highlight the `CorpA` or `CorpB` folder. Now select the `Add SSID` button on the right-hand side of the screen.

Hierarchy Collapsed

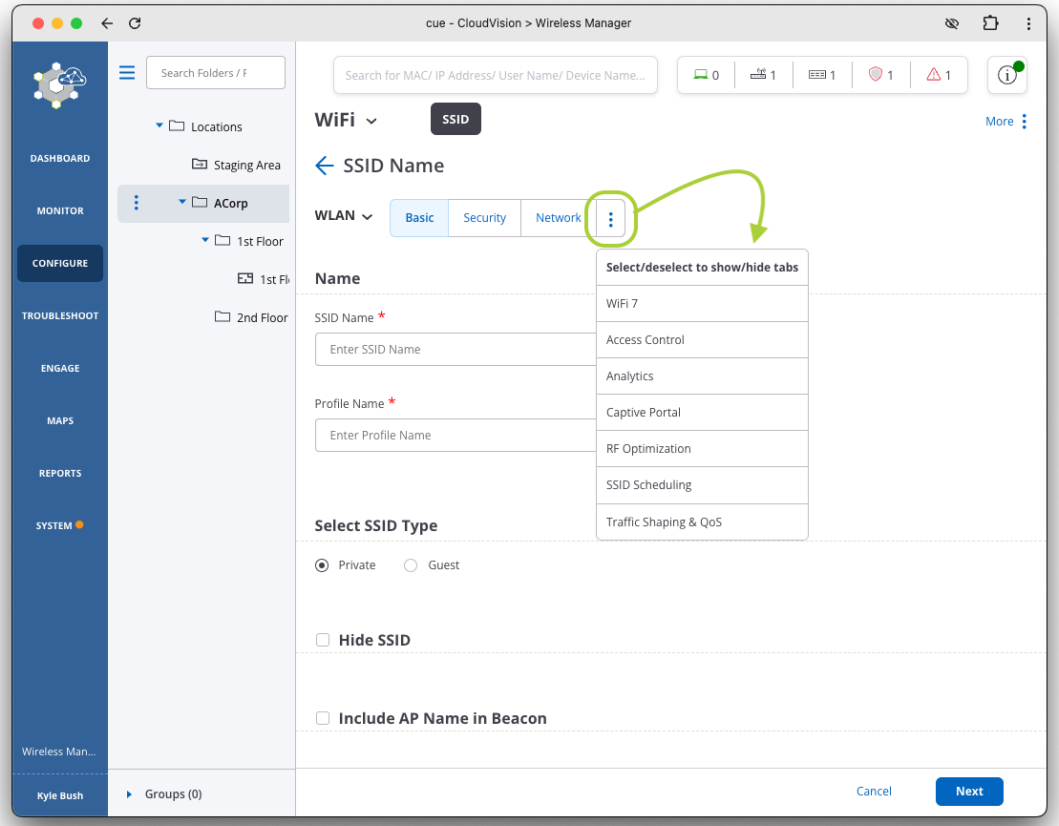


Hierarchy Expanded





3. Once on the `SSID` page, configuration sub-category menu options will appear across the top of the page related to Wi-Fi (the defaults are `Basic`, `Security`, and `Network`). You can select these sub-category names to change configuration items related to that area of the configuration.
4. To make additional categories visible, select the 3 dots ••• next to `Network` and you can see the other categories that are available to configure (`Wifi7`, `Access Controls`, `Captive Portal`, etc.).



5. Walk through the steps (tabs) below to configure the SSID

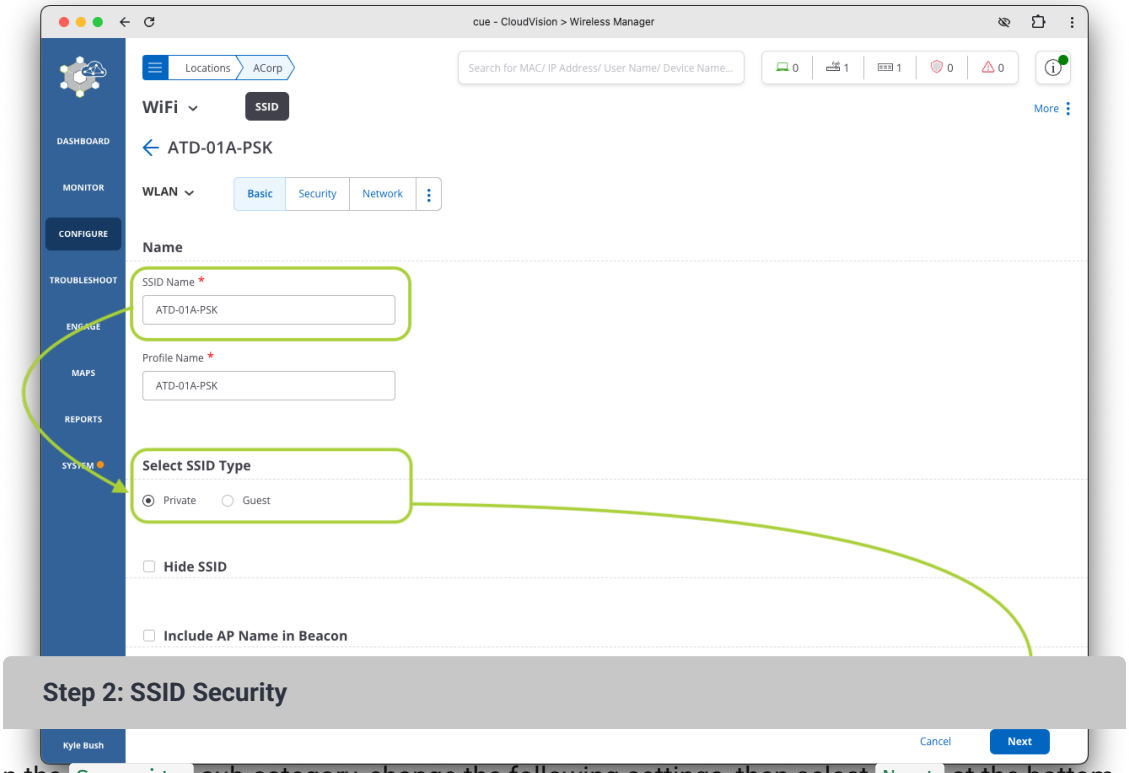
Step 1: SSIDBasic

In the `Basic` sub-category option, name the SSID `ATD-##A/B-PSK` (where ## is the pod number you were assigned). The `Profile Name` is used to describe the SSID and should have been auto-filled for you.

Since this is our corporate SSID, leave the `Select SSID Type` set to `Private`

Guest SSID

Note: this is where you would change it to `Guest` if needed.



Step 2: SSID Security

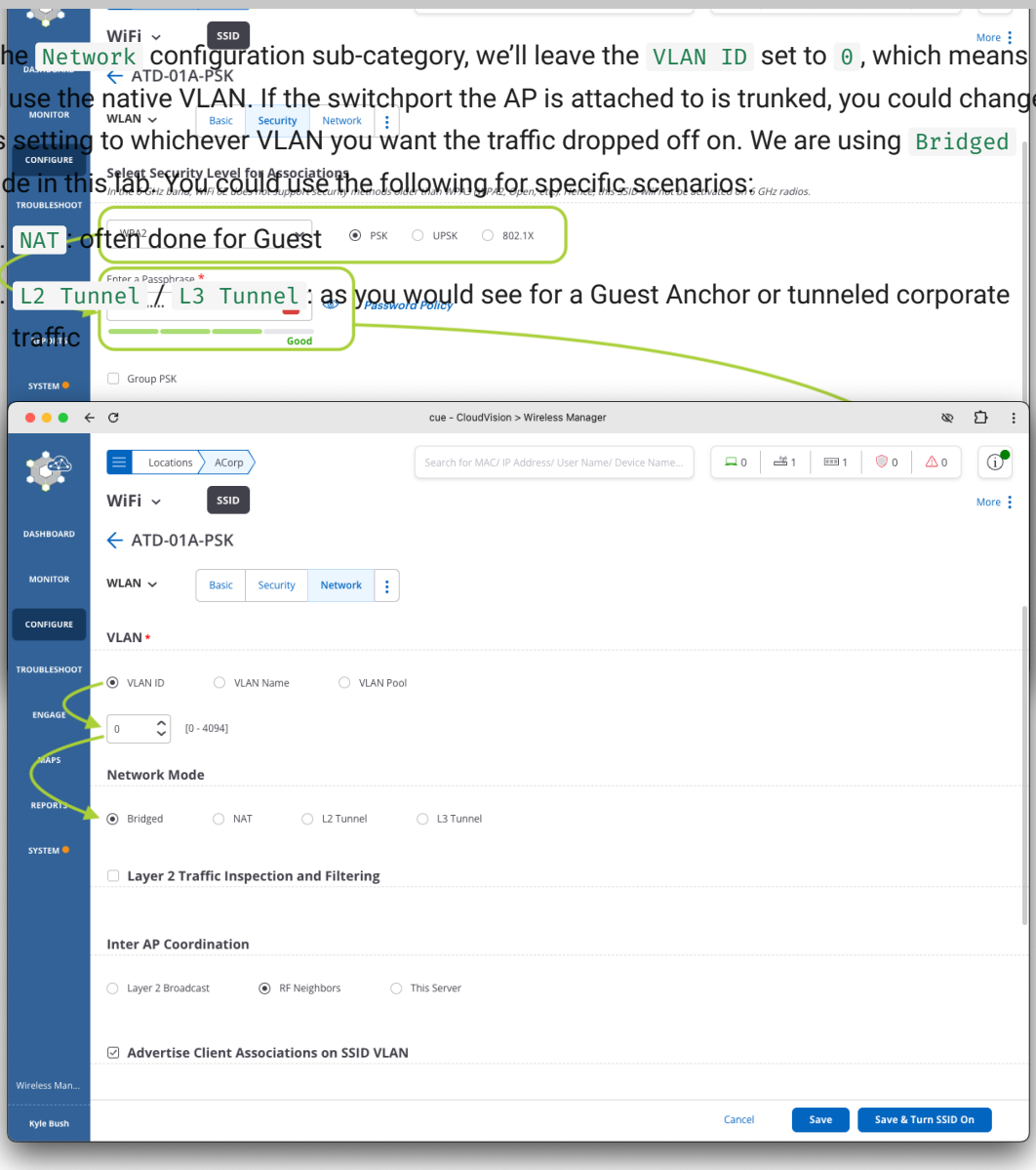
In the `Security` sub-category, change the following settings, then select `Next` at the bottom of the screen.

Step 3: SSID Network

In the `Network` configuration sub-category, we'll leave the `VLAN ID` set to `0`, which means it will use the native VLAN. If the switchport the AP is attached to is trunked, you could change this setting to whichever VLAN you want the traffic dropped off on. We are using `Bridged` mode in this lab. You could use the following for specific scenarios:

a. `NAT`: often done for Guest

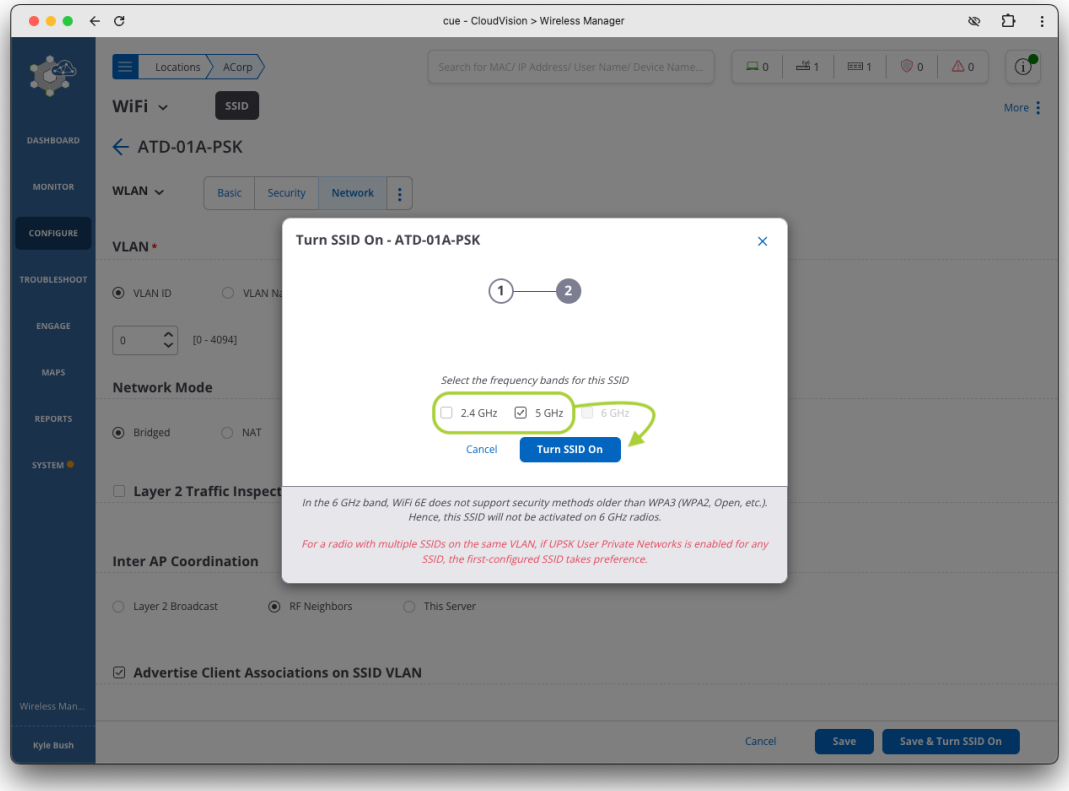
b. `L2 Tunnel` / `L3 Tunnel`: as you would see for a Guest Anchor or tunneled corporate traffic



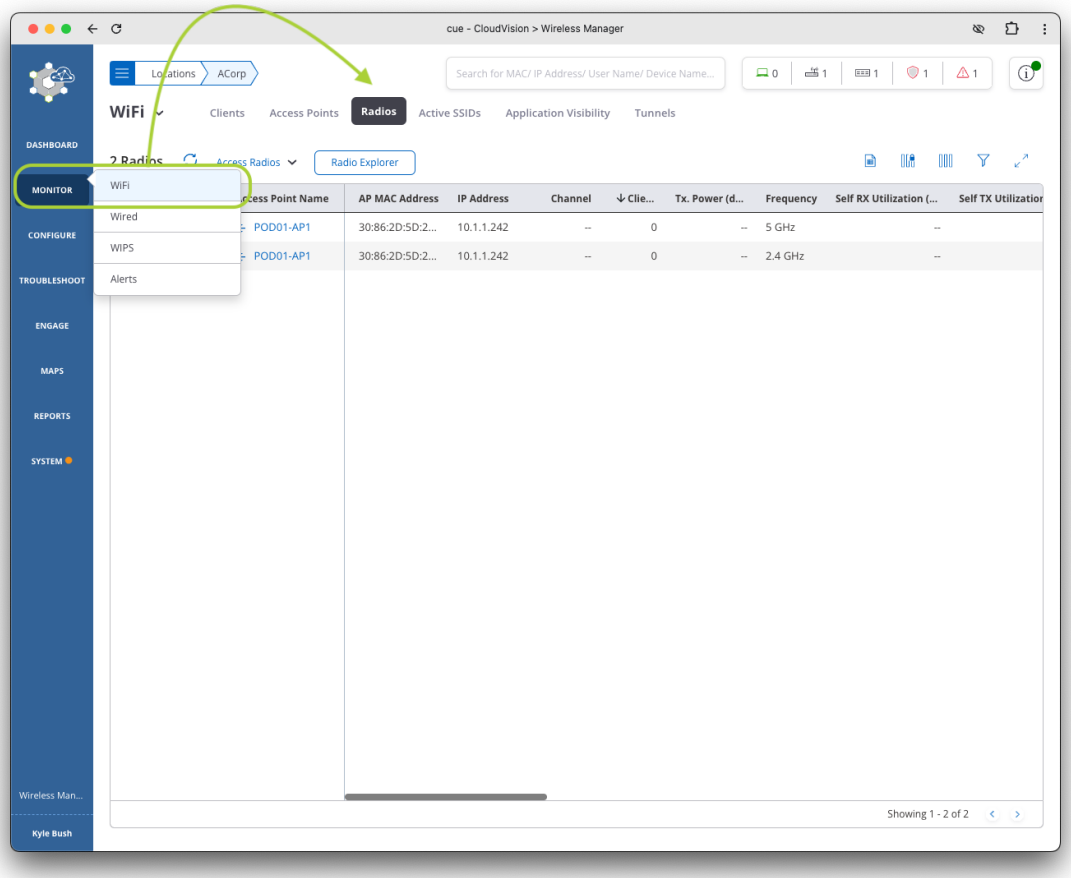
SSID Name

Student	Student 1	Student 2
SSID Name	`ATD-##A-PSK`	`ATD-##B-PSK`
Profile Name	Auto Fill	Auto Fill
Association Type (drop down)	WPA2	WPA2
Authentication (radio button)	PSK	PSK
Passphrase	`Wireless!123`	`Wireless!123`

6. The rest of the settings can be left at the default values.
7. Select the `Save & Turn SSID On` button at the bottom of the page.
8. Only select the `5 GHz` option on the next screen (un-check the `2.4 GHz` box), then select `Turn SSID On`.

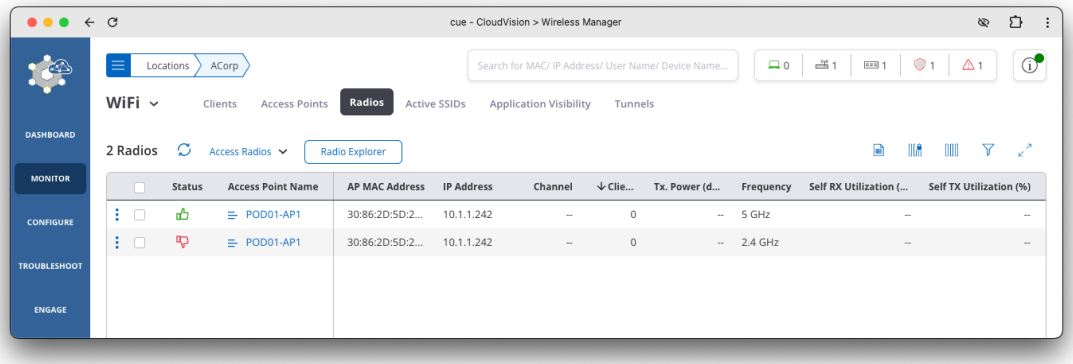


9. After you turn on the SSID, hover your cursor over `Monitor` in the left-hand side menu, and then select `WiFi`.

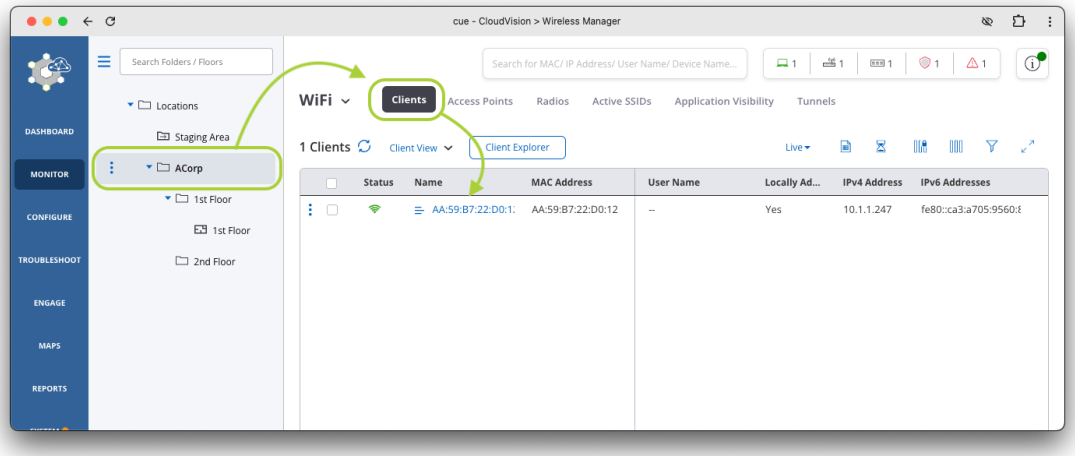


10. Now, in the menu options at the top of the page, look at the `Radios` menu option. Is the 5 GHz radio 👍 (Up) and 2.4 GHz radio 👎 (down)?

> **It may take a minute or two for the radio to become active.**



11. Next, connect your phone to the SSID (PSK is `Wireless!123`). Navigate to the `Clients` menu at the top of the screen and you should see your device.



Additional References

- Wireless Onboarding
- Wireless IPS (WIPS)

🎉 CONGRATS! You have completed this lab! 🎉

LET'S GO TO THE NEXT LAB!

2026-06-10